Bhagavad Gita

भगवद्गीता

An essential English translation



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This English version was prepared from Google Translate output and revised using GPT-5.4/5.5/5.6 and Claude Opus 4.8/5.0, along with some manual editing. The aim was to produce an English translation that is readable, unbiased, and as literal as possible.

The Bhagavad Gita is part of the Mahabharata, Book 6, the Bhishma Parva, chapters 23–40. It is a dialogue set on a battlefield. Its protagonists are Arjuna, who hesitates to fight against his own relatives, and Krishna, an *avatar* of God. Its theme is *dharma*: action in accordance with one's nature and the order of things. The answer is *yoga*: not gymnastics, but discipline (of action, knowledge, and love), free from attachment. The battle may perhaps be read as metaphorical. The text is rightly considered a synthesis and a masterpiece of Indian philosophy.

Chapter 1 - Arjuna Vishada Yoga

1.1 *(Dhritarashtra)*

On the field of dharma, at Kurukshetra, gathered and eager for battle—what did my men and the Pandavas do, O Sanjaya?

1.2 *(Sanjaya)*

Then, seeing the Pandava army drawn up in formation, King Duryodhana approached his teacher and spoke these words.

1.3 *(Sanjaya)*

Behold, O teacher, this great army of the sons of Pandu, arrayed by your skilled disciple, the son of Drupada.

1.4 *(Sanjaya)*

Here are heroes, mighty archers, equal in battle to Bhima and Arjuna: Yuyudhana, Virata, and Drupada, the great chariot-warrior.

1.5 *(Sanjaya)*

Dhrishtaketu, Chekitana, and the valiant king of Kashi; Purujit, Kuntibhoja, and Shaibya, the foremost of men.

1.6 *(Sanjaya)*

The valiant Yudhamanyu and the courageous Uttamauja, Saubhadra and the sons of Draupadi—all great chariot-warriors.

1.7 *(Sanjaya)*

Know too, O best of the twice-born, those who are foremost among us, the leaders of my army; these I name to you.

1.8 *(Sanjaya)*

Yourself, and Bhishma, Karna, and Kripa, ever victorious in battle; Ashvatthama, Vikarna, and Saumadatti as well.

1.9 *(Sanjaya)*

And many other heroes, who have staked their lives for my sake, bearing varied weapons—all skilled in war.

1.10 *(Sanjaya)*

Our force, guarded by Bhishma, is insufficient; but their force, guarded by Bhima, is sufficient.

1.11 *(Sanjaya)*

Stationed in your respective positions throughout the divisions, let all of you protect Bhishma above all.

1.12 *(Sanjaya)*

To cheer him, the aged Kuru, the mighty grandsire, roared like a lion and loudly blew his conch shell.

1.13 *(Sanjaya)*

Then conches, drums, kettledrums, and horns suddenly sounded, and the noise was tumultuous.

1.14 *(Sanjaya)*

Then, stationed in their great chariot yoked with white horses, Madhava and the Pandava blew their divine conches.

1.15 *(Sanjaya)*

Hrishikesha blew the Panchajanya, Dhananjaya the Devadatta, and Vrikodara, of mighty deeds, blew the great conch Paundra.

1.16 *(Sanjaya)*

King Yudhishthira, son of Kunti, blew the Anantavijaya; Nakula and Sahadeva, the Sughosha and the Manipushpaka.

1.17 *(Sanjaya)*

The king of Kashi, supreme archer, and Shikhandin, the great chariot-warrior; Dhrishtadyumna, Virata, and the unconquered Satyaki.

1.18 *(Sanjaya)*

Drupada and the sons of Draupadi, and the strong-armed son of Subhadra—each on every side blew his conch, O lord of the earth.

1.19 *(Sanjaya)*

That tumultuous din, resounding through sky and earth, shaked the hearts of Dhritarashtra's sons.

1.20 *(Sanjaya)*

Then, seeing Dhritarashtra's sons arrayed, as the clash of weapons was about to begin, the Pandava whose banner bore the monkey took up his bow

1.21 *(Arjuna)*

and spoke these words to Hrishikesha, O king: O Acyuta, place my chariot between the two armies,

1.22 *(Arjuna)*

that I may look upon these men standing eager to fight, with whom I must contend in this work of battle.

1.23 *(Arjuna)*

Let me look upon those who have gathered here to fight, seeking to please in battle the evil-minded son of Dhritarashtra.

1.24 *(Sanjaya)*

Thus addressed by Gudakesha, O Bharata, Hrishikesha placed that finest of chariots between the two armies,

1.25 *(Sanjaya)*

before Bhishma and Drona and all the rulers of the earth, and said: "O Partha, behold these Kurus gathered here."

1.26 *(Sanjaya)*

There Partha saw, standing before him, fathers and grandfathers, teachers, uncles, brothers, sons, grandsons, and friends as well;

1.27 *(Sanjaya)*

fathers-in-law and companions too, in both armies. Seeing all these kinsmen arrayed,

1.28 *(Arjuna)*

the son of Kunti was overcome with deep compassion, and in sorrow he said: Seeing my own people, Krishna, gathered here eager to fight,

1.29 *(Arjuna)*

my limbs give way and my mouth goes dry; my body trembles and my hair stands on end.

1.30 *(Arjuna)*

The Gandiva slips from my hand, and my skin burns all over; I cannot stand steady, and my mind seems to reel.

1.31 *(Arjuna)*

And I see adverse omens, O Keshava; I foresee no good in killing my own people in battle.

1.32 *(Arjuna)*

I long for no victory, Krishna, nor kingdom, nor pleasures. What use is a kingdom to us, Govinda, or enjoyments, or even life?

1.33 *(Arjuna)*

Those for whose sake we would want kingdom, enjoyments, and pleasures stand here in battle, having renounced their lives and wealth:

1.34 *(Arjuna)*

teachers, fathers, sons, and grandfathers; uncles, fathers-in-law, grandsons, brothers-in-law, and other kinsmen.

1.35 *(Arjuna)*

I do not wish to kill them, O Madhusudana, even if they were to kill me—not even for the sovereignty of the three worlds, much less for the earth.

1.36 *(Arjuna)*

What joy would be ours, O Janardana, in killing Dhritarashtra's sons? Only sin would fall upon us were we to kill these aggressors.

1.37 *(Arjuna)*

So we ought not to kill Dhritarashtra's sons, our own kinsmen; for how could we be happy, O Madhava, after killing our own people?

1.38 *(Arjuna)*

Even if these men, their minds overcome by greed, see no fault in the ruin of a family and no crime in the betrayal of friends,

1.39 *(Arjuna)*

how should we not know to turn back from this sin, O Janardana, we who clearly see the fault in the ruin of a family?

1.40 *(Arjuna)*

When a family is ruined, its ancient dharmas perish; and when dharma perishes, adharma overcomes the whole family.

1.41 *(Arjuna)*

When adharma prevails, O Krishna, the women of the family are corrupted; and when the women are corrupted, O Varshneya, there arises intermingling of social orders.

1.42 *(Arjuna)*

This confusion brings only hell for the family and for those who ruin it; their ancestors fall, deprived of the offerings of rice and water.

1.43 *(Arjuna)*

By these faults of the family-destroyers, which bring about intermingling of social orders, the eternal dharmas of community and family are undone.

1.44 *(Arjuna)*

And we have heard, O Janardana, that for those whose family dharmas are destroyed, a dwelling in hell is assured.

1.45 *(Arjuna)*

Alas, we are bent on committing a great sin: out of greed for the pleasures of a kingdom, we are prepared to kill our own people.

1.46 *(Arjuna)*

It would be better for me if Dhritarashtra's sons, weapons in hand, were to kill me unresisting and unarmed in the battle.

1.47 *(Sanjaya)*

Having spoken thus on the field of battle, Arjuna sank down upon the seat of the chariot, casting away his bow and arrows, his mind stricken with grief.

Chapter 2 - Sankhya Yoga

2.1 *(Sanjaya)*

Seeing him thus overcome by compassion, his eyes troubled and brimming with tears, Madhusudana spoke these words to the despondent Arjuna.

2.2 *(Krishna)*

Whence has this faintness come upon you in the hour of crisis, Arjuna? It is ignoble, unworthy of an honorable man, and leads neither to heaven nor to fame.

2.3 *(Krishna)*

Do not give way to weakness, Partha; it does not become you. Cast off this base faint-heartedness and rise up, scorcher of foes.

2.4 *(Arjuna)*

How, O Madhusudana, shall I fight back with arrows against Bhishma and Drona, who are worthy of reverence, O destroyer of enemies?

2.5 *(Arjuna)*

Better to live in this world begging for alms than to kill these noble teachers. Were I to kill them, the very pleasures I enjoyed would be stained with blood.

2.6 *(Arjuna)*

And we do not know which is better for us—that we should conquer them, or that they should conquer us; for the sons of Dhritarashtra stand before us, and having killed them we would have no wish to live.

2.7 *(Arjuna)*

My very being is stricken with the weakness of pity, my mind bewildered about my dharma. I ask you: tell me plainly what is best. I am your pupil; I take refuge in you—instruct me.

2.8 *(Arjuna)*

For I see nothing that could drive away the grief withering my senses, even were I to win unrivaled and prosperous dominion on earth, or lordship over the gods.

2.9 *(Sanjaya)*

Having spoken thus to Hrishikesha, Gudakesha, scorcher of foes, said to Govinda, 'I will not fight,' and fell silent.

2.10 *(Sanjaya)*

To him, despondent there between the two armies, Hrishikesha spoke, as if smiling, O Bharata, these words:

2.11 *(Krishna)*

You grieve for those who should not be grieved for, yet you speak words of wisdom. The wise grieve neither for the dead nor for the living.

2.12 *(Krishna)*

Never was there a time when I was not, nor you, nor these lords of men; nor shall any of us cease to be hereafter.

2.13 *(Krishna)*

As the embodied self passes, within this body, through childhood, youth, and age, so it passes to another body; the steady are not bewildered by this.

2.14 *(Krishna)*

The contacts of the senses with their objects, O son of Kunti, bring cold and heat, pleasure and pain; they come and go and do not last. Endure them, O Bharata.

2.15 *(Krishna)*

The one whom these do not trouble, O best of men, who is steady, alike in pain and pleasure—he is fit for immortality.

2.16 *(Krishna)*

Of the unreal there is no being; of the real there is no ceasing to be. The seers of truth have discerned the ultimate nature of both.

2.17 *(Krishna)*

Know that to be indestructible by which all this is pervaded; none can bring about the destruction of this imperishable one.

2.18 *(Krishna)*

These bodies of the eternal embodied self are said to have an end, but the self itself is indestructible and beyond measure; therefore fight, O Bharata.

2.19 *(Krishna)*

He who thinks it the slayer, and he who thinks it slain—neither understands; it neither slays nor is slain.

2.20 *(Krishna)*

It is never born and never dies; having once been, it never ceases to be. Unborn, eternal, everlasting, primeval, it is not killed when the body is killed.

2.21 *(Krishna)*

He who knows it as indestructible, eternal, unborn, and unchanging—how can such a person kill, or cause to be killed, and whom, O Partha?

2.22 *(Krishna)*

As a person casts off worn-out clothes and puts on others that are new, so the embodied self casts off worn-out bodies and takes on others that are new.

2.23 *(Krishna)*

Weapons do not cut it, fire does not burn it; water does not wet it, nor does wind dry it.

2.24 *(Krishna)*

It cannot be cut, burned, wetted, or dried; it is eternal, all-pervading,

firm, unmoving, and primeval.

2.25 *(Krishna)*

It is called unmanifest, unthinkable, and unchanging; therefore, knowing it to be such, you ought not to grieve.

2.26 *(Krishna)*

And even if you suppose it to be constantly born and constantly dying, even then, O mighty-armed one, you ought not to grieve.

2.27 *(Krishna)*

For one who is born, death is certain; for one who dies, birth is certain. Therefore you ought not to grieve over what cannot be avoided.

2.28 *(Krishna)*

Beings are unmanifest in their beginnings, manifest in the middle, and unmanifest again at their end, O Bharata. What occasion for lament is there in this?

2.29 *(Krishna)*

One sees it as a wonder, another speaks of it as a wonder, another hears of it as a wonder; yet even having heard, no one truly knows it.

2.30 *(Krishna)*

The embodied self within the body of every being is forever beyond harm, O Bharata; therefore you ought not to grieve for any being.

2.31 *(Krishna)*

Considering, too, your own dharma, you ought not to waver; for a kshatriya there is no greater good than a battle in accord with dharma.

2.32 *(Krishna)*

Happy the kshatriyas, O Partha, who meet with such a battle, come of itself like an open gate to heaven.

2.33 *(Krishna)*

But if you will not wage this rightful battle, then, forsaking your own dharma and your honor, you will fall into sin.

2.34 *(Krishna)*

People will tell of your lasting disgrace; and for one who has been honored, disgrace is worse than death.

2.35 *(Krishna)*

The great chariot-warriors will think you withdrew from the battle out of fear, and you will fall in the esteem of those who held you high.

2.36 *(Krishna)*

Your enemies will speak many unseemly words, scorning your strength. What could be more painful than that?

2.37 *(Krishna)*

Slain, you will gain heaven; victorious, you will enjoy the earth. Therefore rise up, O son of Kunti, resolved to fight.

2.38 *(Krishna)*

Holding pleasure and pain alike, gain and loss, victory and defeat, gird yourself for battle; thus you will incur no sin.

2.39 *(Krishna)*

This understanding has been declared to you according to Sankhya; now hear it as it bears on yoga. Yoked with this understanding, O Partha, you will cast off the bondage of karma.

2.40 *(Krishna)*

On this path no effort is lost and no harm is done; even a little of this dharma protects one from great fear.

2.41 *(Krishna)*

Here there is but one resolute understanding, O joy of the Kurus; but the thoughts of the irresolute are many-branched and endless.

2.42 *(Krishna)*

This flowery speech is uttered by the unwise, who delight in the letter of the Vedas, O Partha, and declare there is nothing more;

2.43 *(Krishna)*

full of desire and intent on heaven, they offer rites that yield rebirth as the fruit of action, abounding in special ceremonies aimed at enjoyment and power.

2.44 *(Krishna)*

For those attached to enjoyment and power, whose minds are carried away by such talk, no resolute understanding is established in concentration.

2.45 *(Krishna)*

The Vedas treat of the three gunas; be free of the three gunas, O Arjuna—beyond the pairs of opposites, ever poised in purity, free from concern with acquiring and preserving, and possessed of the self.

2.46 *(Krishna)*

As much use as there is in a well when water floods on every side, so much use is there in all the Vedas for the brahmin who knows.

2.47 *(Krishna)*

Your right is to action alone, never to its fruits. Let not the fruits of action be your motive, nor let attachment to inaction take hold in you.

2.48 *(Krishna)*

Established in yoga, perform your actions, abandoning attachment, O Dhananjaya, even-minded in success and failure; this evenness of mind is called yoga.

2.49 *(Krishna)*

Action is far inferior to the yoga of understanding, O Dhananjaya;

take refuge in understanding. Pitiable are those who act for the sake of fruits.

2.50 *(Krishna)*

One yoked in understanding casts off here both good and evil deeds; therefore devote yourself to yoga—yoga is skill in action.

2.51 *(Krishna)*

The wise, yoked in understanding, renounce the fruit born of action and, freed from the bondage of birth, reach the state beyond all ills.

2.52 *(Krishna)*

When your understanding has crossed beyond the thicket of delusion, then you will grow indifferent to what is yet to be heard and what has been heard.

2.53 *(Krishna)*

When your understanding, once bewildered by scriptural lore, stands unmoving and steady in concentration, then you will attain yoga.

2.54 *(Arjuna)*

What is the mark of one whose wisdom is steady, settled in concentration, O Keshava? How does the steady-minded one speak, how sit, how move?

2.55 *(Krishna)*

When a person puts away all the desires that enter the mind, O Partha, and is content within himself by himself, then he is called steady in wisdom.

2.56 *(Krishna)*

He whose mind is untroubled in sorrows and free of craving amid pleasures, gone beyond longing, fear, and anger, is called a sage of steady mind.

2.57 *(Krishna)*

He who is unattached on every side, who neither delights nor recoils at meeting good or ill—his wisdom stands firm.

2.58 *(Krishna)*

And when, like a tortoise drawing in its limbs, he withdraws his senses entirely from their objects, his wisdom stands firm.

2.59 *(Krishna)*

The objects of sense fall away from the embodied one who abstains, though a taste for them remains; even that taste falls away when he sees the Supreme.

2.60 *(Krishna)*

For even in one who strives, O son of Kunti, who sees clearly, the turbulent senses carry off the mind by force.

2.61 *(Krishna)*

Holding all these in check, let him sit yoked, intent on me; for one whose senses are mastered, wisdom stands firm.

2.62 *(Krishna)*

In a person who dwells on the objects of sense, attachment to them is born; from attachment springs desire, and from desire, anger.

2.63 *(Krishna)*

From anger comes delusion; from delusion, the wandering of memory; from the loss of memory, the ruin of understanding; and from the ruin of understanding, the person perishes.

2.64 *(Krishna)*

But one who moves among the objects of sense with senses freed from attachment and aversion, mastered and under his own control, attains serenity.

2.65 *(Krishna)*

In serenity, all his sorrows are dissolved; for the understanding of one whose mind is serene soon becomes steady.

2.66 *(Krishna)*

For the one who is not steady there is no stable understanding and no contemplation; without contemplation there is no peace, and for one without peace, how can there be happiness?

2.67 *(Krishna)*

For when the mind runs after the wandering senses, it carries away one's wisdom, like the wind carries away a boat upon the water.

2.68 *(Krishna)*

Therefore, O mighty-armed one, for the one whose senses are wholly restrained from their objects—his wisdom is firmly established.

2.69 *(Krishna)*

What is night for all beings is the waking of the disciplined one; where beings are awake, there it is night for the sage who sees.

2.70 *(Krishna)*

As the waters flow into the ocean, ever being filled and yet fixed and unmoved, so all desires flow into the one who attains peace—not the one who hankers after desires.

2.71 *(Krishna)*

The person who, abandoning all desires, moves about free of longing, without 'mine' and without ego, attains peace.

2.72 *(Krishna)*

This is the state of Brahman, O Partha; reaching it, one is no longer deluded. Established in it even at the hour of death, one attains the nirvana of Brahman.

Chapter 3 - Karma Yoga

3.1 *(Arjuna)*

Janardana, if you hold understanding to be superior to action, then why, Keshava, do you urge me to this terrible deed?

3.2 *(Arjuna)*

With these seemingly conflicting words you bewilder my understanding. Tell me decisively the one thing by which I may reach the highest good.

3.3 *(Krishna)*

In this world, O blameless one, I have long taught a twofold path: the yoga of knowledge for the followers of Sankhya, and the yoga of action for the yogins.

3.4 *(Krishna)*

Not by abstaining from actions does a person attain freedom from action, nor by renunciation alone does one reach perfection.

3.5 *(Krishna)*

For no one ever remains, even for a moment, without performing action; everyone is driven to act, helpless, by the gunas born of prakriti.

3.6 *(Krishna)*

One who restrains the organs of action yet sits brooding in the mind on the objects of sense, his self deluded, is called a hypocrite.

3.7 *(Krishna)*

But one who, controlling the senses with the mind, undertakes through the organs of action the yoga of action, unattached—he excels, O Arjuna.

3.8 *(Krishna)*

Perform your appointed action, for action is better than inaction;

even the upkeep of your body could not be accomplished by inaction.

3.9 *(Krishna)*

This world is bound by action, except when action is done as yajna; therefore, O son of Kunti, perform your action for that end, free from attachment.

3.10 *(Krishna)*

Having created beings together with yajna, Prajapati said in the beginning: Through yajna you shall prosper; let it be for you like a cow that grants your desires.

3.11 *(Krishna)*

By this nourish the gods, and let the gods nourish you; nourishing one another, you shall attain the highest good.

3.12 *(Krishna)*

Nourished by yajna, the gods will grant you the enjoyments you desire; but one who enjoys their gifts without offering back to them is nothing but a thief.

3.13 *(Krishna)*

The good, who eat the remnants of yajna, are freed from all sins; but the wicked, who cook only for themselves, eat sin.

3.14 *(Krishna)*

From food beings come to be; from rain comes food; from yajna comes rain; and yajna is born of action.

3.15 *(Krishna)*

Know that action springs from Brahman, and Brahman from the imperishable; therefore the all-pervading Brahman is ever present in yajna.

3.16 *(Krishna)*

He who does not follow here the wheel thus set in motion, living

sinfully and delighting in the senses, lives in vain, O Partha.

3.17 *(Krishna)*

But for the one who delights in the self alone, content with the self and satisfied in the self, there is nothing that must be done.

3.18 *(Krishna)*

For him there is no purpose in action done or left undone here, nor does he depend on any being for any end.

3.19 *(Krishna)*

Therefore, ever unattached, perform the action that must be done; for the person who works unattached attains the highest.

3.20 *(Krishna)*

It was by action alone that Janaka and others attained perfection; and with an eye to the holding-together of the world, you too should act.

3.21 *(Krishna)*

Whatever the eminent person does, that the rest will do; whatever standard he sets, the world follows it.

3.22 *(Krishna)*

There is nothing in the three worlds I need to do, O Partha, nor anything unattained that I must gain; yet I remain engaged in action.

3.23 *(Krishna)*

For if I did not remain ever tireless in action, O Partha, people would follow my way in every respect.

3.24 *(Krishna)*

These worlds would fall to ruin if I did not perform action; I would be the maker of confusion and would destroy these creatures.

3.25 *(Krishna)*

As the ignorant act with attachment to action, O Bharata, so should

the wise act, but unattached, seeking the welfare of the world.

3.26 *(Krishna)*

Let the wise not unsettle the minds of the ignorant who are attached to action; acting with discipline himself, he should engage them in all their actions.

3.27 *(Krishna)*

Actions are in every way performed by the gunas of prakriti; one whose mind is deluded by ego thinks, "I am the doer."

3.28 *(Krishna)*

But one who knows the truth, O mighty-armed one, about the divisions of guna and action is not bound, knowing that it is the gunas that act among the gunas.

3.29 *(Krishna)*

Those deluded by the gunas of prakriti grow attached to the actions of the gunas; let the one who knows the whole not unsettle the dull who do not.

3.30 *(Krishna)*

Surrendering all actions to me, with mind fixed on the self, free of longing and of any sense of 'mine,' fight, your fever gone.

3.31 *(Krishna)*

Those who constantly follow this teaching of mine, full of faith and free from cavil, are released even from their karma.

3.32 *(Krishna)*

But those who, finding fault, do not follow this teaching of mine—know them to be deluded in all knowledge, mindless, and lost.

3.33 *(Krishna)*

Even the wise act according to their own nature; beings follow their nature—what can restraint accomplish?

3.34 *(Krishna)*

In each sense, attraction and aversion are seated toward its object; let no one fall under their power, for they are one's enemies.

3.35 *(Krishna)*

Better one's own dharma, imperfectly done, than another's dharma well performed. Better to die in one's own dharma; another's dharma brings danger.

3.36 *(Arjuna)*

Then by what is a person driven to do evil, O Varshneya, even against his will, as if compelled by force?

3.37 *(Krishna)*

It is desire, it is anger, born of the guna of rajas—all-devouring, deeply harmful; know it here to be the enemy.

3.38 *(Krishna)*

As fire is veiled by smoke, a mirror by dust, and an embryo by the womb, so is this veiled by that.

3.39 *(Krishna)*

Knowledge is veiled, O son of Kunti, by this constant enemy of the wise—desire, an insatiable fire.

3.40 *(Krishna)*

The senses, the mind, and the understanding are said to be its seat; through these it veils knowledge and deludes the embodied one.

3.41 *(Krishna)*

Therefore, O best of the Bharatas, first master your senses, then strike down this evil thing, the destroyer of knowledge and discernment.

3.42 *(Krishna)*

The senses, they say, are superior; higher than the senses is the mind; higher than the mind is the understanding; and higher than

the understanding is the self.

3.43 *(Krishna)*

Thus knowing it to be higher than the understanding, and steadying the self by the self, slay the enemy, O mighty-armed one, in the form of desire, so hard to subdue.

Chapter 4 - Jnana-Karma-Sannyasa Yoga

4.1 *(Krishna)*

I taught this imperishable yoga to Vivasvan; Vivasvan told it to Manu, and Manu told it to Ikshvaku.

4.2 *(Krishna)*

Thus handed down in succession, the royal sages knew it; but over the long course of time, O scorcher of foes, this yoga was lost here on earth.

4.3 *(Krishna)*

It is this very same ancient yoga that I have declared to you today, for you are my devotee and my friend; for this is the supreme secret.

4.4 *(Arjuna)*

Your birth was later, the birth of Vivasvan earlier; how then am I to understand that you taught it in the beginning?

4.5 *(Krishna)*

Many births of mine have passed, and yours as well, O Arjuna; I know them all, but you do not, O scorcher of foes.

4.6 *(Krishna)*

Though I am unborn and imperishable, and the lord of beings, yet, governing my own prakriti, I come into being through my own maya.

4.7 *(Krishna)*

Whenever dharma declines, O Bharata, and adharma rises up, then I send forth myself.

4.8 *(Krishna)*

For the protection of the good and the destruction of the wicked, and to set dharma firmly in place, I come into being age after age.

4.9 *(Krishna)*

He who truly knows my divine birth and action, on leaving the body is not born again but comes to me, Arjuna.

4.10 *(Krishna)*

Freed from passion, fear, and anger, filled with me and taking refuge in me, many, purified by the austerity of knowledge, have attained my state of being.

4.11 *(Krishna)*

As they approach me, so do I receive them; people follow my path in every way, O Partha.

4.12 *(Krishna)*

Desiring success in their works, people here worship the gods; for in the human world success born of action comes quickly.

4.13 *(Krishna)*

The four varnas were brought forth by me, apportioned by guna and action. Though I am their maker, know me as the one who does not act, the changeless.

4.14 *(Krishna)*

Actions do not taint me, nor do I crave the fruits of action; one who knows me thus is not bound by actions.

4.15 *(Krishna)*

Knowing this, the ancient seekers of liberation also performed action; therefore do action, as the ancients did of old.

4.16 *(Krishna)*

What is action? What is inaction? On this even the wise are bewildered. I shall declare to you the action by knowing which you will be freed from ill.

4.17 *(Krishna)*

One must understand action, and must understand wrong action, and must understand inaction too; deep is the way of action.

4.18 *(Krishna)*

He who sees inaction in action, and action in inaction, is wise among men; he is disciplined, a doer of every action.

4.19 *(Krishna)*

He whose every undertaking is free of desire and design, whose actions are burned up in the fire of knowledge—him the wise call learned.

4.20 *(Krishna)*

Having given up attachment to the fruits of action, ever content and dependent on nothing, he does nothing at all, even while fully engaged in action.

4.21 *(Krishna)*

Free of expectation, mind and self controlled, abandoning all possessions, he performs action with the body alone and incurs no fault.

4.22 *(Krishna)*

Content with whatever comes unsought, beyond the pairs of opposites, free of envy, even in success and failure, he is not bound even when he acts.

4.23 *(Krishna)*

For one who is unattached and free, whose mind is settled in knowledge, who acts as yajna—his action dissolves entirely.

4.24 *(Krishna)*

The act of offering is Brahman, the oblation is Brahman, poured by Brahman into the fire of Brahman; Brahman is what he reaches who is absorbed in the action that is Brahman.

4.25 *(Krishna)*

Some yogins offer sacrifice to the gods alone; others offer the very sacrifice as an offering into the fire of Brahman.

4.26 *(Krishna)*

Some offer hearing and the other senses into the fires of restraint; others offer sound and the other objects of sense into the fires of the senses.

4.27 *(Krishna)*

And others offer all the workings of the senses and the workings of the breath into the fire of self-control, kindled by knowledge.

4.28 *(Krishna)*

Others again make their sacrifice with wealth, with austerity, with yoga, and with study and knowledge—ascetics of stern vows.

4.29 *(Krishna)*

Others offer the outgoing breath into the incoming, and the incoming into the outgoing, restraining the course of both, intent on breath-control;

4.30 *(Krishna)*

and others, of measured diet, offer the breaths into the breaths. All these know what sacrifice is, and by sacrifice their faults are wiped away.

4.31 *(Krishna)*

Those who eat the nectar left from yajna go to the eternal Brahman. This world is not for the one who offers no sacrifice—how then the next, O best of the Kurus?

4.32 *(Krishna)*

Thus sacrifices of many kinds are spread out before Brahman. Know them all to be born of action; knowing this, you will be freed.

4.33 *(Krishna)*

Better than any sacrifice of goods is the sacrifice of knowledge, O scorcher of foes; for all action, without exception, culminates in knowledge, O Partha.

4.34 *(Krishna)*

Learn this by reverence, by inquiry, and by service; the knowers who see the truth will impart that knowledge to you.

4.35 *(Krishna)*

Knowing it, O Pandava, you will not fall again into such delusion; by it you will see all beings, without exception, within yourself, and then within me.

4.36 *(Krishna)*

Even if you were the worst sinner among all sinners, you would cross over all wrongdoing by the boat of knowledge alone.

4.37 *(Krishna)*

As a kindled fire turns its fuel to ashes, O Arjuna, so the fire of knowledge turns all karma to ashes.

4.38 *(Krishna)*

There is no purifier here equal to knowledge; one perfected in yoga finds it of itself, in time, within the self.

4.39 *(Krishna)*

The one full of faith, intent on it, his senses mastered, attains knowledge; and having attained knowledge, he soon reaches supreme peace.

4.40 *(Krishna)*

But the ignorant and faithless, the doubting self, comes to ruin; neither this world nor the next nor any happiness is for the doubting self.

4.41 *(Krishna)*

Actions do not bind the one who has renounced action through yoga, whose doubts are cut away by knowledge, who is possessed of the self, O Dhananjaya.

4.42 *(Krishna)*

Therefore, with the sword of knowledge cut away this doubt in your

heart, born of ignorance; take up yoga and rise, O Bharata.

Chapter 5 - Sannyasa Yoga

5.1 *(Arjuna)*

O Krishna, you praise the renunciation of actions, and again the yoga of action; tell me for certain which of the two is better.

5.2 *(Krishna)*

Both renunciation and the yoga of action lead to the highest good; but of the two, the yoga of action excels the renunciation of action.

5.3 *(Krishna)*

Know him to be a constant renunciant who neither hates nor desires; free of the pairs of opposites, O mighty-armed one, he is released from bondage with ease.

5.4 *(Krishna)*

It is the childish, not the wise, who speak of Sankhya and yoga as different; one rightly established in even one of them gains the fruit of both.

5.5 *(Krishna)*

The state reached by Sankhya is reached by yoga as well; he who sees Sankhya and yoga as one truly sees.

5.6 *(Krishna)*

But renunciation is hard to attain without yoga, O mighty-armed one; the sage yoked in yoga soon reaches Brahman.

5.7 *(Krishna)*

Yoked in yoga, his self purified, self-mastered, his senses subdued, his self become the self of all beings—he is not tainted even while acting.

5.8 *(Krishna)*

"I do nothing at all," the disciplined knower of truth would hold, even while seeing, hearing, touching, smelling, eating, moving, sleeping,

breathing,

5.9 *(Krishna)*

speaking, discharging, grasping, opening and closing the eyes—convinced that it is only the senses moving among the objects of sense.

5.10 *(Krishna)*

One who acts, offering his actions to Brahman and abandoning attachment, is untouched by sin, as a lotus leaf by water.

5.11 *(Krishna)*

With body, mind, understanding, and the senses alone, the yogins act, abandoning attachment, for the purifying of the self.

5.12 *(Krishna)*

The disciplined one, abandoning the fruit of action, attains lasting peace; the undisciplined, attached to the fruit through desire, is bound.

5.13 *(Krishna)*

Renouncing all actions with the mind, the embodied one rests at ease, in command, in the city of nine gates [the body], neither acting nor causing action.

5.14 *(Krishna)*

The Lord creates for the world neither agency nor actions, nor the joining of action to its fruit; it is inherent nature that unfolds.

5.15 *(Krishna)*

The all-pervading Lord takes on no one's sin or merit; knowledge is veiled by ignorance, and by this beings are deluded.

5.16 *(Krishna)*

But for those in whom that ignorance is destroyed by knowledge of the self, knowledge, like the sun, lights up the Supreme.

5.17 *(Krishna)*

With understanding fixed on it, their self set on it, devoted to it, intent on it as their goal, they go where there is no return, their faults washed away by knowledge.

5.18 *(Krishna)*

On a learned and humble brahmin, on a cow, an elephant, a dog, and an outcaste, the wise look with an equal eye.

5.19 *(Krishna)*

Even here rebirth is overcome by those whose minds rest in equanimity; for Brahman is flawless and the same in all, and so they are established in Brahman.

5.20 *(Krishna)*

Neither rejoicing at the pleasant nor recoiling at the unpleasant, steady of understanding and unbewildered, the knower of Brahman is established in Brahman.

5.21 *(Krishna)*

With the self unattached to outward contacts, he finds the happiness that is in the self; his self yoked in the yoga of Brahman, he attains unending happiness.

5.22 *(Krishna)*

For the pleasures born of contact are wombs of suffering; they have a beginning and an end, O son of Kunti, and the wise take no delight in them.

5.23 *(Krishna)*

He who can withstand, even here, before he is freed from the body, the force born of desire and anger—he is disciplined, he is a happy man.

5.24 *(Krishna)*

He whose happiness is within, whose delight is within, whose light too

is within—that yogin, having become Brahman, attains the nirvana of Brahman.

5.25 *(Krishna)*

The seers whose sins are spent, whose doubts are cut away, who are self-mastered and rejoice in the welfare of all beings, attain the nirvana of Brahman.

5.26 *(Krishna)*

For ascetics freed from desire and anger, their minds controlled, who have known the self, the nirvana of Brahman lies near on every side.

5.27 *(Krishna)*

Shutting out the outward contacts, fixing the gaze between the brows, making the inward and outward breaths even as they move through the nostrils,

5.28 *(Krishna)*

the sage who has mastered his senses, mind, and understanding, intent on liberation, freed of desire, fear, and anger, is forever free.

5.29 *(Krishna)*

Knowing me as the enjoyer of sacrifices and austerities, the great lord of all the worlds, the friend of every being, he attains peace.

Chapter 6 - Atma-Samyama Yoga

6.1 *(Krishna)*

He who performs the action that ought to be done, not depending on its fruit, is a renunciant and a yogin—not the one who lights no fire and does no rite.

6.2 *(Krishna)*

Know that what they call renunciation is yoga, O Pandava; for none becomes a yogin without renouncing self-will.

6.3 *(Krishna)*

For the sage who seeks to rise to yoga, action is said to be the means; for one who has risen to yoga, stillness is said to be the means.

6.4 *(Krishna)*

When one is attached neither to the objects of sense nor to actions, having renounced all self-will, then one is said to have risen to yoga.

6.5 *(Krishna)*

Let one lift one's own self by the self; let one not drag the self down. For the self alone is the friend of self, and the self alone is the enemy of the self.

6.6 *(Krishna)*

For one who whose self has been conquered by the self, the self is a friend; but for one who has not mastered the self, the self remains hostile, like an enemy.

6.7 *(Krishna)*

For one who has mastered the self and is at peace, the supreme Atman [Self] stays steady, alike in cold and heat, pleasure and pain, honor and dishonor.

6.8 *(Krishna)*

The yogin who is content in knowledge and realization, unwavering,

with his senses subdued, to whom a clod, a stone, and gold are alike, is said to be yoked.

6.9 *(Krishna)*

He who is even-minded toward well-wisher, friend, and foe, toward the neutral and the mediator, toward the hateful and the kinsman, and toward the good and the wicked alike, stands supreme.

6.10 *(Krishna)*

Let the yogin discipline the atman constantly, staying in solitude, alone, his mind and the self controlled, free of longing and of possessions.

6.11 *(Krishna)*

Having set up a firm seat for himself in a clean place, neither too high nor too low, covered with cloth, deerskin, and kusha grass,

6.12 *(Krishna)*

there, making the mind one-pointed, the workings of mind and senses checked, seated on that seat, let him practice yoga to purify the atman.

6.13 *(Krishna)*

Holding body, head, and neck erect and still, steady, gazing at the tip of his own nose without looking about,

6.14 *(Krishna)*

his mind serene and free of fear, firm in the vow of celibacy, the mind controlled and thought fixed on me, let him sit, yoked, intent on me.

6.15 *(Krishna)*

Thus ever disciplining himself, the yogin of controlled mind attains the peace that culminates in nirvana and abides in me.

6.16 *(Krishna)*

Yoga is not for one who eats too much, nor for one who eats nothing

at all, nor for one given to too much sleep, nor for one always awake, Arjuna.

6.17 *(Krishna)*

For one measured in food and recreation, measured in his actions, measured in sleep and waking, yoga becomes the destroyer of sorrow.

6.18 *(Krishna)*

When the disciplined mind comes to rest in the self alone, free of longing for any desire, then one is said to be yoked.

6.19 *(Krishna)*

As a lamp in a windless place does not flicker—such is the image of the yogin of controlled mind, practicing the yoga of the self.

6.20 *(Krishna)*

When the mind, restrained by the practice of yoga, comes to rest, and seeing the self by the self, one is content within the self;

6.21 *(Krishna)*

when one knows that boundless happiness, grasped by the understanding [buddhi] and beyond the senses, and, established in it, never strays from the truth;

6.22 *(Krishna)*

and, having gained it, counts no other gain greater—established in it, he is unshaken even by the heaviest sorrow:

6.23 *(Krishna)*

let it be known that this severance of all union with sorrow is what is called yoga; that yoga is to be practiced with resolve and an undismayed mind.

6.24 *(Krishna)*

Abandoning without remainder all desires born of self-will, restraining the whole host of senses on every side by the mind alone,

6.25 *(Krishna)*

little by little let him grow still, the understanding held firm; fixing the mind on the self, let him think of nothing at all.

6.26 *(Krishna)*

Wherever the restless, unsteady mind wanders off, from there let him rein it back under the control of the self.

6.27 *(Krishna)*

For supreme happiness comes to the yogin whose mind is at peace, whose passion is stilled, who is free of taint and has become Brahman.

6.28 *(Krishna)*

Thus ever disciplining himself, the yogin, freed of taint, easily attains the boundless happiness of contact with Brahman.

6.29 *(Krishna)*

His self yoked in yoga, he sees the self present in all beings and all beings in the self, seeing the same everywhere.

6.30 *(Krishna)*

For one who sees me everywhere and sees all things in me, I am not lost to him, nor is he lost to me.

6.31 *(Krishna)*

The yogin who, established in oneness, worships me as dwelling in all beings abides in me, in whatever way he lives.

6.32 *(Krishna)*

He who, by analogy with the self, sees the same everywhere, Arjuna, whether in happiness or in suffering, is regarded as the highest yogin.

6.33 *(Arjuna)*

This yoga of equanimity you have taught, O Madhusudana, I do not see how it can stand firm, because the mind is so restless.

6.34 *(Arjuna)*

For the mind is restless, Krishna—turbulent, strong, and unyielding; to restrain it, I think, is as hard as to restrain the wind.

6.35 *(Krishna)*

No doubt, O mighty-armed one, the mind is hard to restrain and restless; but by practice, O son of Kunti, and by dispassion it is held in check.

6.36 *(Krishna)*

Yoga is hard to reach, such is my view, for one whose self is unrestrained; but for one who strives, self-controlled, it can be attained by the right means.

6.37 *(Arjuna)*

One of faith who does not strive, whose mind has strayed from yoga and failed to reach its perfection—what end does he meet, O Krishna?

6.38 *(Arjuna)*

Fallen from both, does he not perish like a scattered cloud, without support, O mighty-armed one, bewildered on the path of Brahman?

6.39 *(Arjuna)*

You are fit, O Krishna, to dispel this doubt of mine completely; for none but you can be found to remove it.

6.40 *(Krishna)*

O Partha, neither here nor hereafter is there ruin for him; for no one who does good, my friend, ever comes to a bad end.

6.41 *(Krishna)*

Having reached the worlds of those who do right and dwelt there countless years, the one fallen from yoga is born in the house of the pure and prosperous;

6.42 *(Krishna)*

or else he is born into a family of wise yogins—though a birth like this is harder still to win in this world.

6.43 *(Krishna)*

There he regains the union of understanding gained in his former body, and from there strives once more toward perfection, O joy of the Kurus.

6.44 *(Krishna)*

By that very former practice he is carried onward, even against his will; even one who merely seeks to know yoga passes beyond the word of the Vedas.

6.45 *(Krishna)*

But the yogin who strives with effort, cleansed of all faults, perfected through many births, then reaches the supreme goal.

6.46 *(Krishna)*

The yogin is greater than the ascetics, greater, it is held, than the men of knowledge, and greater than the men of action; therefore become a yogin, Arjuna.

6.47 *(Krishna)*

And of all yogins, the one who, full of faith, worships me with his inmost self drawn to me—him I hold to be the most deeply yoked.

Chapter 7 - Jnana-Vijnana Yoga

7.1 *(Krishna)*

With your mind clinging to me, O Partha, practicing yoga and taking refuge in me, hear how you shall know me fully and beyond doubt.

7.2 *(Krishna)*

I shall declare to you in full this knowledge together with its realization; once you know it, nothing further remains to be known here.

7.3 *(Krishna)*

Among thousands of people, scarcely one strives for perfection; and of those who strive and succeed, scarcely one knows me in truth.

7.4 *(Krishna)*

Earth, water, fire, air, ether, mind, understanding, and ego—so is my prakriti divided eightfold.

7.5 *(Krishna)*

This is my lower nature; but know my other nature, the higher, O mighty-armed one—the living principle by which this world is sustained.

7.6 *(Krishna)*

Know that all beings have their womb in these; I am the origin of the whole universe, and its dissolution as well.

7.7 *(Krishna)*

There is nothing higher than me, O Dhananjaya; on me all this is strung, like rows of gems upon a thread.

7.8 *(Krishna)*

I am the taste in water, O son of Kunti, the light in moon and sun, the syllable Om in all the Vedas, the sound in space, the manhood in men.

7.9 *(Krishna)*

I am the pure fragrance in the earth and the brightness in fire; I am the life in all beings and the austerity in ascetics.

7.10 *(Krishna)*

Know me, O Partha, as the eternal seed of all beings; I am the understanding of the wise, the splendor of the splendid.

7.11 *(Krishna)*

I am the strength of the strong, free of desire and passion; in beings I am desire that does not conflict with dharma, O chief of the Bharatas.

7.12 *(Krishna)*

Whatever states of the gunas there are—of sattva, of rajas, or of tamas—know them all to come from me; yet I am not in them, but they are in me.

7.13 *(Krishna)*

Deluded by these three states made of the gunas, this whole world does not know me, who am above them and imperishable.

7.14 *(Krishna)*

For this divine maya of mine, made of the gunas, is hard to cross; but those who take refuge in me alone pass beyond this maya.

7.15 *(Krishna)*

The evildoers, the deluded, the lowest of men, their knowledge stripped away by maya, given over to a demonic nature, do not take refuge in me.

7.16 *(Krishna)*

Four kinds of those who do good worship me, Arjuna: the distressed, the seeker of knowledge, the seeker of gain, and the wise, O best of the Bharatas.

7.17 *(Krishna)*

Of these, the wise one, ever disciplined, devoted to the one alone,

stands highest; for to the wise I am exceedingly dear, and he is dear to me.

7.18 *(Krishna)*

All of these are noble, but the wise one I hold to be my very self; for, steady in himself, he is set on me alone as the highest goal.

7.19 *(Krishna)*

At the end of many births the wise one comes to me, knowing that Vasudeva is all; such a great soul is very rare.

7.20 *(Krishna)*

Those whose knowledge is carried off by this or that desire take refuge in other gods, following this and that observance, constrained by their own nature.

7.21 *(Krishna)*

Whatever form a devotee seeks to worship with faith, it is I who make that faith of his steady.

7.22 *(Krishna)*

Yoked with that faith, he seeks to honor that form, and from it obtains his desires—though it is I alone who grant them.

7.23 *(Krishna)*

But the fruit won by these small-minded ones is finite; those who worship the gods go to the gods, while those devoted to me come to me.

7.24 *(Krishna)*

The unwise take me, the unmanifest, to have come into manifest being, not knowing my higher nature, imperishable and supreme.

7.25 *(Krishna)*

Veiled by my yoga-maya, I am not manifest to all; this deluded world does not know me, the unborn and imperishable.

7.26 *(Krishna)*

I know the beings that are past, that are present, and that are to come, O Arjuna; but no one knows me.

7.27 *(Krishna)*

By the delusion of the pairs of opposites, sprung from desire and aversion, O Bharata, all beings fall into bewilderment at birth, O scorcher of foes.

7.28 *(Krishna)*

But those of pure deeds, whose sins have ended, freed from the delusion of the pairs of opposites, worship me with firm resolve.

7.29 *(Krishna)*

Those who, taking refuge in me, strive for release from old age and death know that Brahman, the whole inner principle, and the whole of action.

7.30 *(Krishna)*

Those who know me together with the material domain, the divine principle, and the sacrificial principle, their minds yoked, know me even at the hour of death.

Chapter 8 - Akshara-Brahma Yoga

8.1 *(Arjuna)*

What is that Brahman? What is the inner principle? What is action, O Purushottama? What is called the material domain, and what the divine principle?

8.2 *(Arjuna)*

Who, and how, is the sacrificial principle here in this body, O Madhusudana? And how, at the hour of death, are you to be known by the self-controlled?

8.3 *(Krishna)*

Brahman is the supreme, the imperishable; one's own essential being is called the inner principle. The creative force that brings beings into existence is called action.

8.4 *(Krishna)*

The material domain is perishable existence; the purusha is the divine principle; and the sacrificial principle is I myself, here within the body, O best of the embodied.

8.5 *(Krishna)*

And whoever, at the hour of death, remembering me alone, departs, leaving the body, attains my being; of this there is no doubt.

8.6 *(Krishna)*

Whatever state one calls to mind as he leaves the body at the end, to that very state he goes, O son of Kunti, ever shaped by that thought.

8.7 *(Krishna)*

Therefore at all times remember me, and fight; with mind and understanding fixed on me, you shall come to me, beyond doubt.

8.8 *(Krishna)*

With the mind disciplined by practice and not straying elsewhere, one reaches the supreme divine person, meditating on him, O Partha.

8.9 *(Krishna)*

Whoever meditates on the ancient seer, the ruler of all, smaller than the small, the sustainer of all, of form beyond thought, sunlike in color, beyond the darkness—

8.10 *(Krishna)*

at the hour of departure, with mind unmoving, joined with devotion and the power of yoga, setting the breath rightly between the brows, he reaches that supreme divine person.

8.11 *(Krishna)*

That state which the knowers of the Veda call imperishable, which ascetics free of passion enter, and seeking which they live in celibacy—that state I shall declare to you in brief.

8.12 *(Krishna)*

Closing all the gates, confining the mind in the heart, drawing the breath up into the head, established in the concentration of yoga,

8.13 *(Krishna)*

uttering the single syllable Om, which is Brahman, and remembering me, he who departs, leaving the body, reaches the supreme goal.

8.14 *(Krishna)*

For the yogin who, undistracted, remembers me constantly, day after day, I am easy to reach, O Partha—for the ever-disciplined one.

8.15 *(Krishna)*

Having reached me, the great souls are not born again into this fleeting home of sorrow; they have attained the highest perfection.

8.16 *(Krishna)*

From the world of Brahma downward, all worlds are subject to re-

turn, Arjuna; but having reached me, O son of Kunti, there is no rebirth.

8.17 *(Krishna)*

Those who know that Brahma's day lasts a thousand ages, and his night ends after a thousand ages—they are the knowers of day and night.

8.18 *(Krishna)*

At the coming of day all manifest things arise from the unmanifest; at the coming of night they dissolve into that same unmanifest.

8.19 *(Krishna)*

This same host of beings, coming to be again and again, dissolves helplessly at the coming of night, O Partha, and comes forth at the coming of day.

8.20 *(Krishna)*

But beyond this unmanifest is another, eternal unmanifest, which does not perish when all beings perish.

8.21 *(Krishna)*

This unmanifest, called the imperishable, is named the supreme goal; reaching it, they do not return—that is my supreme abode.

8.22 *(Krishna)*

That supreme person, O Partha, in whom all beings dwell and by whom all this is pervaded, is to be reached by undivided devotion.

8.23 *(Krishna)*

Now I shall tell you, O best of the Bharatas, the time at which yogins who depart go to no return, and the time at which they return.

8.24 *(Krishna)*

Fire, light, day, the bright fortnight, the six months of the sun's northward course—departing then, those who know Brahman go to Brahman.

8.25 *(Krishna)*

Smoke, night, the dark fortnight, the six months of the southward course—by these the yogin reaches the lunar light and returns.

8.26 *(Krishna)*

These two paths of the world, the bright and the dark, are held to be eternal; by the one a person goes to no return, by the other he returns again.

8.27 *(Krishna)*

Knowing these two paths, O Partha, no yogin is deluded; therefore at all times be yoked in yoga, Arjuna.

8.28 *(Krishna)*

The yogin who knows all this passes beyond whatever fruit of merit is laid down for the Vedas, for sacrifices, austerities, and gifts, and reaches the supreme, primal abode.

Chapter 9 - Raja-Vidya Raja-Guhya Yoga

9.1 *(Krishna)*

To you, who do not cavil, I shall declare this most secret knowledge together with its realization; knowing it, you will be freed from ill.

9.2 *(Krishna)*

This is the royal knowledge, the royal secret, the supreme purifier, plain to direct experience, in keeping with dharma, easy to practice, and imperishable.

9.3 *(Krishna)*

People who put no faith in this dharma, O scorcher of foes, fail to reach me and return to the path of death and samsara.

9.4 *(Krishna)*

By me, in my unmanifest form, this whole world is pervaded; all beings dwell in me, but I do not dwell in them.

9.5 *(Krishna)*

And yet beings do not dwell in me—behold my sovereign yoga! Sustaining beings, yet not dwelling in them, my self is what brings beings into being.

9.6 *(Krishna)*

As the vast wind, moving everywhere, abides always in space, so, understand, all beings abide in me.

9.7 *(Krishna)*

All beings, O son of Kunti, pass into my prakriti at the end of an aeon, and at the aeon's beginning I send them forth again.

9.8 *(Krishna)*

Resting on my own prakriti, I send forth again and again this whole host of beings, helpless under the sway of prakriti.

9.9 *(Krishna)*

Nor do these actions bind me, O Dhananjaya; I remain seated apart, unattached to those actions.

9.10 *(Krishna)*

Under my oversight, prakriti gives birth to all that moves and does not move; by this cause, O son of Kunti, the world turns round.

9.11 *(Krishna)*

The foolish scorn me when I have taken on a human form, not knowing my higher being as the great lord of beings.

9.12 *(Krishna)*

Their hopes vain, their actions vain, their knowledge vain, bereft of sense, they fall into a deluding nature, fiendish and demonic.

9.13 *(Krishna)*

But the great souls, O Partha, sheltering in the divine nature, worship me with undivided mind, knowing me as the imperishable source of beings.

9.14 *(Krishna)*

Ever glorifying me, striving with firm vows, bowing before me with devotion, they worship me, ever steadfast.

9.15 *(Krishna)*

Others, offering the sacrifice of knowledge, worship me in oneness, in separateness, and in manifold forms, as the one whose faces are everywhere.

9.16 *(Krishna)*

I am the rite, I am the sacrifice, I am the offering to the ancestors, I am the herb; I am the sacred formula, I am the melted butter, I am the fire, I am the oblation.

9.17 *(Krishna)*

I am the father of this world, its mother, sustainer, and forefather; the object of knowledge, the purifier, the syllable Om, and the Rig,

the Sama, and the Yajur Veda.

9.18 *(Krishna)*

I am the goal, the upholder, the lord, the witness, the dwelling, the refuge, the friend; the origin, the dissolution, the ground, the resting place, the imperishable seed.

9.19 *(Krishna)*

I give heat; I hold back the rain and send it forth; I am immortality and death, being and nonbeing, Arjuna.

9.20 *(Krishna)*

The knowers of the three Vedas, who drink the soma and are cleansed of sin, worship me with sacrifices and seek the way to heaven; reaching the holy world of Indra, they taste in heaven the divine pleasures of the gods.

9.21 *(Krishna)*

Having enjoyed that vast world of heaven, their merit spent, they enter the world of mortals; so, following the dharma of the three Vedas and craving pleasures, they come and go.

9.22 *(Krishna)*

But those who, thinking of no other, worship me, ever yoked to me—for them I secure what they lack and preserve what they have.

9.23 *(Krishna)*

Even those devoted to other gods who worship them with faith, O son of Kunti, worship me too, though not in the appointed way.

9.24 *(Krishna)*

For I am the enjoyer and the lord of all sacrifices; but they do not know me in truth, and so they fall.

9.25 *(Krishna)*

Those who worship the gods go to the gods; those who worship the ancestors go to the ancestors; those who worship the spirits go to

the spirits; but those who worship me come to me.

9.26 *(Krishna)*

Whoever offers me with devotion a leaf, a flower, a fruit, or water—that offering of devotion, given by the pure of heart, I accept.

9.27 *(Krishna)*

Whatever you do, whatever you eat, whatever you offer or give, whatever austerity you practice, O son of Kunti, do it as an offering to me.

9.28 *(Krishna)*

So you will be freed from the bonds of action, from its good and evil fruits; your self yoked in the yoga of renunciation, set free, you will come to me.

9.29 *(Krishna)*

I am the same toward all beings; none is hateful to me and none dear; but those who worship me with devotion are in me, and I too am in them.

9.30 *(Krishna)*

Even one of very evil conduct who worships me, devoted to none else, is to be reckoned among the good, for his resolve is right.

9.31 *(Krishna)*

Swiftly he becomes righteous of soul and attains lasting peace; know it for certain, O son of Kunti—no one devoted to me is lost.

9.32 *(Krishna)*

For those who take refuge in me, O Partha, even if born of a lowly womb—women, vaishyas, and shudras—even they reach the supreme goal.

9.33 *(Krishna)*

How much more, then, the pure brahmins and devoted royal sages! Having come to this fleeting, joyless world, worship me.

9.34 *(Krishna)*

Fix your mind on me, be devoted to me, sacrifice to me, bow before me; so, yoking yourself, with me as your highest goal, you will come to me.

Chapter 10 - Vibhuti Yoga

10.1 *(Krishna)*

Once more, O mighty-armed one, hear my supreme word, which I shall speak to you, who are dear to me, desiring your good.

10.2 *(Krishna)*

Neither the hosts of gods nor the great sages know my origin; for I am the source of the gods and of the great sages in every way.

10.3 *(Krishna)*

He who knows me as unborn and beginningless, the great lord of the worlds, is undeluded among mortals and freed from all sins.

10.4 *(Krishna)*

Understanding, knowledge, freedom from delusion, patience, truth, self-restraint, and calm; pleasure and pain, becoming and passing away, fear and fearlessness;

10.5 *(Krishna)*

nonviolence, evenness, contentment, austerity, charity, fame and disrepute—these varied states of beings arise from me alone.

10.6 *(Krishna)*

The seven great sages, the four ancients, and the Manus, sharing my nature, were born of my mind; from them sprang these creatures of the world.

10.7 *(Krishna)*

He who knows in truth this glory and yoga of mine is yoked with unshaken yoga; of this there is no doubt.

10.8 *(Krishna)*

I am the origin of all; from me everything proceeds. Knowing this, the wise, filled with fervor, worship me.

10.9 *(Krishna)*

Their minds set on me, their lives given over to me, enlightening one another and ever speaking of me, they are content and glad.

10.10 *(Krishna)*

To these, ever yoked to me and worshiping me with love, I give that yoga of understanding by which they come to me.

10.11 *(Krishna)*

Out of compassion for them, dwelling within their hearts, I destroy the darkness born of ignorance with the shining lamp of knowledge.

10.12 *(Arjuna)*

You are the supreme Brahman, the supreme abode, the supreme purifier; the eternal divine person, the primal god, unborn and all-pervading.

10.13 *(Arjuna)*

So all the sages declare you—the divine seer Narada, Asita, Devala, and Vyasa—and you yourself tell me so.

10.14 *(Arjuna)*

I hold all this that you tell me to be true, O Keshava; for neither the gods nor the danavas know your manifestation, O Bhagavan.

10.15 *(Arjuna)*

You alone know yourself by yourself, O Purushottama—source of beings, lord of beings, god of gods, lord of the world.

10.16 *(Arjuna)*

Tell me, then, in full, of your divine glories, by which you pervade these worlds and abide in them.

10.17 *(Arjuna)*

How shall I know you, O yogin, by constant meditation? In what forms, O Bhagavan, are you to be contemplated by me?

10.18 *(Arjuna)*

Tell me again, in detail, O Janardana, of your yoga and your glories; for I am not sated with hearing this nectar.

10.19 *(Krishna)*

So be it: I shall tell you of my divine glories—but only the chief of them, O best of the Kurus, for there is no end to my extent.

10.20 *(Krishna)*

I am the Atman, O Gudakesha, seated in the heart of all beings; I am the beginning, the middle, and the end of beings.

10.21 *(Krishna)*

Among the Adityas I am Vishnu; among lights, the radiant sun; among the Maruts I am Marichi; among the stars, the moon.

10.22 *(Krishna)*

Among the Vedas I am the Sama Veda; among the gods, Vasava; among the senses I am the mind; in beings I am consciousness.

10.23 *(Krishna)*

Among the Rudras I am Shankara; among the yakshas and rakshasas, the lord of wealth; among the Vasus I am fire; among mountains, Meru.

10.24 *(Krishna)*

Among household priests, O Partha, know me to be their chief, Brihaspati; among generals I am Skanda; among waters, the ocean.

10.25 *(Krishna)*

Among the great sages I am Bhrigu; among utterances, the single syllable Om; among sacrifices, the sacrifice of silent repetition; among the unmoving, the Himalaya.

10.26 *(Krishna)*

Among all trees I am the ashvattha; among divine sages, Narada; among the gandharvas, Chitraratha; among the perfected, the sage Kapila.

10.27 *(Krishna)*

Know me, among horses, as Uchchaihshravas, born of the nectar; among lordly elephants, Airavata; and among men, the king.

10.28 *(Krishna)*

Among weapons I am the thunderbolt; among cows, the wish-granting cow; among begetters I am Kandarpa; among serpents, Vasuki.

10.29 *(Krishna)*

Among the nagas I am Ananta; among water-dwellers, Varuna; among the ancestors, Aryaman; among those who govern, Yama.

10.30 *(Krishna)*

Among the daityas I am Prahlada; among reckoners, time itself; among beasts I am the lion, and among birds, Garuda.

10.31 *(Krishna)*

Among purifiers I am the wind; among warriors, Rama; among fishes I am the makara, and among rivers, the Ganges.

10.32 *(Krishna)*

Of creations I am the beginning, the end, and the middle, Arjuna; of branches of knowledge, the knowledge of the self; among debaters, I am the reasoned argument.

10.33 *(Krishna)*

Of letters I am "A"; of compounds I am the copulative compound. I am inexhaustible time, and the ordainer whose faces are everywhere.

10.34 *(Krishna)*

I am all-devouring death, and the origin of things to come; among women I am fame, fortune, speech, memory, wisdom, steadfastness, and patience.

10.35 *(Krishna)*

Of the Sama chants I am the Brihat-sama; of meters, the Gayatri; of months I am Margashirsha; of seasons, the flowering spring.

10.36 *(Krishna)*

I am the gambling of the deceitful and the splendor of the splendid; I am victory, I am resolve, I am the sattva of the good.

10.37 *(Krishna)*

Among the Vrishnis I am Vasudeva; among the Pandavas, Dhananjaya; among sages I am Vyasa; among seers, Ushanas the seer.

10.38 *(Krishna)*

Among those who chastise I am the rod; among those who seek victory, statecraft; among secrets I am silence; and I am the knowledge of the knowing.

10.39 *(Krishna)*

And I am the seed of all beings, Arjuna; there is nothing moving or unmoving that could exist without me.

10.40 *(Krishna)*

There is no end to my divine glories, O scorcher of foes; what I have declared of my extent is but a glimpse of it.

10.41 *(Krishna)*

Whatever being is glorious, prosperous, or mighty, know that it springs from a fragment of my splendor.

10.42 *(Krishna)*

But what need have you to know all this in detail, Arjuna? I stand supporting this whole world with a single fragment of myself.

Chapter 11 - Vishvarupa-Darshana Yoga

11.1 *(Arjuna)*

Out of grace toward me you have spoken the supreme secret known as the teaching of the self; by it this delusion of mine is dispelled.

11.2 *(Arjuna)*

For I have heard from you in full of the coming-to-be and passing-away of beings, O lotus-eyed one, and of your imperishable majesty.

11.3 *(Arjuna)*

As you describe yourself, O supreme lord, even so I long to see your sovereign form, O Purushottama.

11.4 *(Arjuna)*

If you think it can be seen by me, O lord, then show me your imperishable self, O lord of yoga.

11.5 *(Krishna)*

Behold, O Partha, my forms by the hundreds and thousands, of many kinds, divine, of many colors and shapes.

11.6 *(Krishna)*

See the Adityas, the Vasus, the Rudras, the two Ashvins, and the Maruts; see many wonders never seen before, O Bharata.

11.7 *(Krishna)*

See now, gathered here in one place, the whole world, moving and unmoving, within my body, O Gudakesha, and whatever else you wish to see.

11.8 *(Krishna)*

But you cannot see me with this, your own eye; I give you a divine eye—behold my sovereign yoga.

11.9 *(Sanjaya)*

Having spoken thus, O king, Hari, the great lord of yoga, then showed Partha his supreme sovereign form:

11.10 *(Sanjaya)*

with many mouths and eyes, with many wondrous aspects, with many divine ornaments, and many divine weapons raised on high;

11.11 *(Sanjaya)*

wearing divine garlands and garments, anointed with divine perfumes, all-wondrous, resplendent, boundless, with faces on every side.

11.12 *(Sanjaya)*

If the light of a thousand suns were to blaze forth at once in the sky, it might resemble the splendor of that great being.

11.13 *(Sanjaya)*

There the Pandava saw the whole world in its manifold divisions, gathered together in one place, in the body of the god of gods.

11.14 *(Sanjaya)*

Then Dhananjaya, filled with wonder, his hair standing on end, bowed his head before the god and, with joined palms, spoke:

11.15 *(Arjuna)*

I see all the gods in your body, O god, and the various hosts of beings—Brahma the lord seated on the lotus, the seers, and the divine serpents.

11.16 *(Arjuna)*

I see you with countless arms, bellies, mouths, and eyes, endless on every side; I see in you no end, no middle, no beginning, O lord of all, O universal form.

11.17 *(Arjuna)*

I see you with crown, mace, and discus, a mass of radiance blazing on every side, hard to look upon, immeasurable, like the flaming fire

and the sun.

11.18 *(Arjuna)*

You are the imperishable, the supreme to be known; you are the ultimate resting place of this universe; you are the undying guardian of eternal dharma; you, I hold, are the everlasting person.

11.19 *(Arjuna)*

I see you without beginning, middle, or end, of boundless power, with countless arms, the moon and sun your eyes, your face a blazing fire, scorching this whole universe with your radiance.

11.20 *(Arjuna)*

For this space between heaven and earth, and all the quarters, is pervaded by you alone; seeing this wondrous, terrible form of yours, the three worlds tremble, O great soul.

11.21 *(Arjuna)*

Into you these hosts of gods are entering; some, in fear, with folded hands, praise you; the hosts of great seers and the perfected, crying 'all hail,' extol you with abundant hymns.

11.22 *(Arjuna)*

The Rudras, Adityas, Vasus, and Sadhyas, the Vishvedevas, the two Ashvins, the Maruts, and the ancestors, the hosts of gandharvas, yakshas, asuras, and the perfected—all gaze upon you in amazement.

11.23 *(Arjuna)*

Seeing your great form, O mighty-armed one, with its many mouths and eyes, its many arms, thighs, and feet, its many bellies, and terrible with many fangs—the worlds tremble, and so do I.

11.24 *(Arjuna)*

Seeing you touch the sky, ablaze with many colors, your mouths gaping, your great eyes aflame, my inmost self trembles, O Vishnu; I find neither steadiness nor peace.

11.25 *(Arjuna)*

Seeing your mouths, terrible with fangs, like the fire at the world's end, I lose all sense of direction and find no refuge; be gracious, O lord of the gods, O dwelling of the world.

11.26 *(Arjuna)*

And all these sons of Dhritarashtra, along with the throng of kings—Bhishma, Drona, and that son of a charioteer too, together with the chief warriors on our side—

11.27 *(Arjuna)*

rush into your mouths, fearsome with fangs; some are seen with their heads crushed, caught between your teeth.

11.28 *(Arjuna)*

As the many torrents of rivers rush toward the sea, so these heroes of the human world enter your blazing mouths.

11.29 *(Arjuna)*

As moths fly headlong into a blazing flame to their destruction, so do these worlds rush headlong into your mouths to their destruction.

11.30 *(Arjuna)*

You lick up all the worlds on every side with your flaming mouths, devouring them; your fierce rays fill the whole universe with light and scorch it, O Vishnu.

11.31 *(Arjuna)*

Tell me who you are, so terrible in form. Homage to you, O best of gods; be gracious. I long to know you, the primal one, for I do not comprehend your working.

11.32 *(Krishna)*

I am Time, grown mighty, destroyer of the worlds, here at work to gather the worlds in. Even without you, the warriors arrayed in the opposing ranks shall all cease to be.

11.33 *(Krishna)*

Therefore rise up and win glory; conquer your foes and enjoy a flourishing kingdom. By me they are already slain; be only the instrument, O Savyasachin.

11.34 *(Krishna)*

Drona, Bhishma, Jayadratha, Karna, and the other warrior-heroes as well—slay them, already slain by me; do not waver. Fight! You will conquer your rivals in battle.

11.35 *(Sanjaya)*

Hearing these words of Keshava, the diademed one, trembling, joined his palms and bowed; then, prostrating himself in terror, he spoke again to Krishna in a faltering voice:

11.36 *(Arjuna)*

Rightly, O Hrishikesha, does the world rejoice and delight in your praise; the rakshasas flee in terror in every direction, and all the hosts of the perfected bow down.

11.37 *(Arjuna)*

And why should they not bow to you, O great soul, greater even than Brahma, the first creator? O boundless one, lord of the gods, dwelling of the world, you are the imperishable—being, nonbeing, and what is beyond both.

11.38 *(Arjuna)*

You are the primal god, the ancient person, the supreme resting place of this universe; you are the knower and the known, the highest abode; by you the universe is pervaded, O you of endless forms.

11.39 *(Arjuna)*

You are Vayu, Yama, Agni, Varuna, the moon, Prajapati, and the great-grandsire; homage to you a thousandfold, and again and again, homage, homage to you.

11.40 *(Arjuna)*

Homage to you before and behind, homage to you on every side, O all; boundless in power and measureless in might, you encompass all, and so you are all.

11.41 *(Arjuna)*

Thinking you a friend, I addressed you rashly—'Krishna! Yadava! my friend!'—not knowing this greatness of yours, through heedlessness or through love.

11.42 *(Arjuna)*

And if, in jest, I slighted you while at play, resting, sitting, or at meals, alone or before others, O Acyuta, I beg your forgiveness, O immeasurable one.

11.43 *(Arjuna)*

You are the father of this world, moving and unmoving, its object of worship and most venerable teacher; there is none equal to you; how then could any be greater, O you of matchless power in the three worlds?

11.44 *(Arjuna)*

Therefore, bowing low and prostrating my body, I beg your grace, O lord worthy of praise; as a father with a son, a friend with a friend, a lover with the beloved, bear with me, O god.

11.45 *(Arjuna)*

Glad am I to have seen what was never seen before, yet my mind trembles with fear; show me, O god, that very form again; be gracious, O lord of the gods, O dwelling of the world.

11.46 *(Arjuna)*

I wish to see you as before, crowned, bearing mace and discus in hand; take on again that four-armed form, O thousand-armed one, O universal form.

11.47 *(Krishna)*

Out of grace toward you, Arjuna, by my own yoga I have shown you this supreme form—radiant, universal, boundless, primeval—which none but you has ever seen.

11.48 *(Krishna)*

Not by the Vedas and sacrifices, not by study, gifts, rites, or severe austerities can I be seen in this form in the world of men by any but you, O foremost of the Kurus.

11.49 *(Krishna)*

Do not tremble, do not be bewildered, at seeing this terrible form of mine; with fear gone and glad heart, behold once more this very form of mine.

11.50 *(Sanjaya)*

Having spoken thus to Arjuna, Vasudeva showed his own form again; and the great soul, taking on once more his gentle shape, comforted the terrified one.

11.51 *(Arjuna)*

Seeing your gentle human form again, O Janardana, I have come to my senses and returned to my own nature.

11.52 *(Krishna)*

This form of mine that you have seen is very hard to behold; even the gods long forever to see this form.

11.53 *(Krishna)*

Not by the Vedas, nor by austerity, nor by gifts, nor by sacrifice can I be seen in the form in which you have seen me.

11.54 *(Krishna)*

But by undivided devotion, O Arjuna, I can be known, and seen, and truly entered into, O scorcher of foes.

11.55 *(Krishna)*

He who does his work for me, who holds me as the highest, devoted to me, free of attachment, without enmity toward any being—he comes to me, O Pandava.

Chapter 12 - Bhakti Yoga

12.1 *(Arjuna)*

Those devotees who, ever steadfast, worship you, and those who worship the imperishable and unmanifest—which of them better know yoga?

12.2 *(Krishna)*

Those who fix their minds on me and, ever steadfast, worship me with supreme faith—them I hold to be the most perfect in yoga.

12.3 *(Krishna)*

But those who worship the imperishable, the undefinable, the unmanifest, all-pervading and unthinkable, unchanging, fixed, and still—

12.4 *(Krishna)*

having restrained the whole host of senses, even-minded in all circumstances, rejoicing in the welfare of all beings—they too attain me.

12.5 *(Krishna)*

Greater is the toil of those whose minds are set on the unmanifest; for the unmanifest goal is hard for the embodied to reach.

12.6 *(Krishna)*

But those who, surrendering all actions to me, intent on me, worship me, meditating with undivided yoga,

12.7 *(Krishna)*

For them, whose minds are absorbed in me, I soon become the deliverer from the ocean of death and samsara, O Partha.

12.8 *(Krishna)*

Fix your mind on me alone, rest your understanding in me; thereafter you will dwell in me alone—of this there is no doubt.

12.9 *(Krishna)*

But if you cannot fix your mind steadily on me, then seek to reach me by the yoga of practice, O Dhananjaya.

12.10 *(Krishna)*

If you are unable even to practice, be intent on working for me; doing your actions for my sake, you too will attain perfection.

12.11 *(Krishna)*

And if even this you cannot do, then, taking refuge in my yoga, with self subdued, give up the fruit of all action.

12.12 *(Krishna)*

Knowledge is better than practice; meditation surpasses knowledge; better than meditation is the renouncing of the fruits of action—from such renouncing, peace follows at once.

12.13 *(Krishna)*

He who hates no being, who is friendly and compassionate, free of possessiveness and ego, even in pain and pleasure, and forgiving;

12.14 *(Krishna)*

ever content, the yogin self-controlled, of firm resolve, his mind and understanding given to me—he who is devoted to me is dear to me.

12.15 *(Krishna)*

He from whom the world is not disturbed, and who is not disturbed by the world, who is free from joy, resentment, fear, and agitation—he is dear to me.

12.16 *(Krishna)*

He who is not dependent on anything, pure, capable, impartial, and untroubled, who has renounced all undertakings—that devotee of mine is dear to me.

12.17 *(Krishna)*

He who neither rejoices nor hates, neither grieves nor longs, who has given up concern with good and bad outcomes—that devotee of mine

is dear to me.

12.18 *(Krishna)*

The same to foe and friend, the same in honor and dishonor, the same in cold and heat, in pleasure and pain, free of attachment;

12.19 *(Krishna)*

weighing blame and praise alike, silent, content with whatever comes, without a fixed home, steady of mind, full of devotion—such a person is dear to me.

12.20 *(Krishna)*

But those who honor this nectar of dharma, as I have told it, full of faith and holding me as the highest—those devotees are exceedingly dear to me.

Chapter 13 - Kshetra-Kshetrajna Vibhaga Yoga

13.1 *(Arjuna)*

I wish to know prakriti and purusha, the field and the knower of the field, and knowledge and what is to be known, O Keshava.

13.2 *(Krishna)*

This body, O son of Kunti, is called the field; and the one who knows it, those who know call the knower of the field.

13.3 *(Krishna)*

Know me too, O Bharata, as the knower of the field in all fields; and the knowledge of the field and its knower—that, I hold, is true knowledge.

13.4 *(Krishna)*

What that field is, of what kind, with what changes, whence it arises, and who he is and what his powers are—hear this from me in brief.

13.5 *(Krishna)*

This has been sung by seers in many ways, in various hymns, and in well-reasoned, conclusive aphorisms concerning Brahman.

13.6 *(Krishna)*

The great elements, the ego, the understanding, and the unmanifest; the ten senses and the one mind, and the five fields of sense;

13.7 *(Krishna)*

desire and aversion, pleasure and pain, the bodily whole, awareness, and steadfastness—this, in brief, is the field together with its changes.

13.8 *(Krishna)*

Humility, sincerity, nonviolence, patience, uprightness, service to the teacher, purity, steadiness, and self-restraint;

13.9 *(Krishna)*

indifference to the objects of sense, absence of ego, and a clear sight of the evil in birth, death, old age, sickness, and pain;

13.10 *(Krishna)*

non-attachment, freedom from clinging to son, wife, home, and the rest, and a constant evenness of mind toward the welcome and the unwelcome;

13.11 *(Krishna)*

unswerving devotion to me through undistracted yoga, resort to secluded places, and no delight in crowds of people;

13.12 *(Krishna)*

constancy in knowledge of the self and insight into the aim of true knowledge—this is declared to be knowledge; what differs from it is ignorance.

13.13 *(Krishna)*

I shall declare what is to be known, knowing which one gains the deathless: the beginningless supreme Brahman, said to be neither being nor nonbeing.

13.14 *(Krishna)*

With hands and feet on every side, with eyes, heads, and faces on every side, with ears on every side, it abides, enfolding all in the world.

13.15 *(Krishna)*

Shining through the powers of all the senses, yet free of all the senses; unattached, yet bearing all; without gunas, yet enjoying the gunas;

13.16 *(Krishna)*

outside and inside all beings; unmoving, yet moving; too subtle to be known; far away, and yet near.

13.17 *(Krishna)*

Undivided, yet seeming divided among beings; this is to be known

as the sustainer of beings, their devourer and their source.

13.18 *(Krishna)*

It is the light even of lights, said to be beyond darkness; it is knowledge, the object of knowledge, to be reached by knowledge, seated in the hearts of all.

13.19 *(Krishna)*

Thus the field, knowledge, and the knowable have been told in brief; one devoted to me, knowing this, becomes fit for my being.

13.20 *(Krishna)*

Know that both prakriti and purusha are without beginning; and know that the changes and the gunas are born of prakriti.

13.21 *(Krishna)*

Prakriti is said to be the cause in the working of cause and effect; purusha is said to be the cause in the experiencing of pleasure and pain.

13.22 *(Krishna)*

For purusha, seated in prakriti, experiences the gunas born of prakriti; attachment to the gunas is the cause of its birth in good and evil wombs.

13.23 *(Krishna)*

The supreme purusha in this body is also called the witness, the one who permits, the sustainer, the experiencer, the great lord, and the supreme Atman.

13.24 *(Krishna)*

He who thus knows purusha and prakriti, together with the gunas, in whatever state he lives, is not born again.

13.25 *(Krishna)*

Some, by meditation, see the self in the self by the self; others by the yoga of Sankhya, and others by the yoga of action.

13.26 *(Krishna)*

Others, not knowing this themselves, worship as they have heard it from others; they too, devoted to what they hear, cross beyond death.

13.27 *(Krishna)*

Whatever being is born, moving or unmoving, know it to arise from the union of kshetra and kshetrajna, O best of the Bharatas.

13.28 *(Krishna)*

He who sees the supreme lord dwelling alike in all beings, undying amid the dying, truly sees.

13.29 *(Krishna)*

For seeing the lord present the same everywhere, he does not harm the self by the self, and so reaches the supreme goal.

13.30 *(Krishna)*

He who sees that actions are performed in every way by prakriti alone, and that the self is not the doer, truly sees.

13.31 *(Krishna)*

When he sees the separate states of beings as resting in the One, and their spreading forth from that alone, then he attains Brahman.

13.32 *(Krishna)*

Beginningless and without gunas, this supreme self, imperishable, though seated in the body, O son of Kunti, neither acts nor is tainted.

13.33 *(Krishna)*

As all-pervading space, being subtle, is not tainted, so the self, seated everywhere in the body, is not tainted.

13.34 *(Krishna)*

As the one sun lights up this whole world, so the knower of the field lights up the whole field, O Bharata.

13.35 *(Krishna)*

Those who, with the eye of knowledge, thus discern the difference between kshetra and kshetrajna, and the freeing of beings from prakriti, reach the Supreme.

Chapter 14 - Guna-Traya Vibhaga Yoga

14.1 *(Krishna)*

I shall declare again the supreme knowledge, the best of all knowledge, by knowing which all the sages have passed from here to the highest perfection.

14.2 *(Krishna)*

Taking refuge in this knowledge, they come to share my nature; they are not born at creation, nor troubled at dissolution.

14.3 *(Krishna)*

The great Brahman is my womb; in it I place the seed, and from it, O Bharata, comes the birth of all beings.

14.4 *(Krishna)*

Whatever forms take birth in all wombs, O son of Kunti, the great Brahman is their womb, and I am the father who gives the seed.

14.5 *(Krishna)*

Sattva, rajas, and tamas—the gunas born of prakriti—bind fast in the body, O mighty-armed one, the imperishable embodied one.

14.6 *(Krishna)*

Of these, sattva, being pure, is luminous and free of ill; it binds, O blameless one, by attachment to happiness and to knowledge.

14.7 *(Krishna)*

Know rajas to be of the nature of passion, born of craving and attachment; it binds the embodied one, O son of Kunti, by attachment to action.

14.8 *(Krishna)*

But know tamas, born of ignorance, to delude all embodied beings; it binds them by carelessness, sloth, and sleep, O Bharata.

14.9 *(Krishna)*

Sattva binds one to happiness, rajas to action, O Bharata; but tamas, veiling knowledge, binds one to carelessness.

14.10 *(Krishna)*

Sattva prevails by mastering rajas and tamas, O Bharata; rajas, by mastering sattva and tamas; and tamas likewise, by mastering sattva and rajas.

14.11 *(Krishna)*

When the light of knowledge shines forth through all the gates of this body, then one should know that sattva has grown strong.

14.12 *(Krishna)*

Greed, busy activity, the undertaking of works, restlessness, and longing—these arise when rajas has grown strong, O best of the Bharatas.

14.13 *(Krishna)*

Darkness, inertia, carelessness, and mere delusion—these arise when tamas has grown strong, O joy of the Kurus.

14.14 *(Krishna)*

When the embodied one meets death while sattva prevails, he attains the spotless worlds of those who know the highest.

14.15 *(Krishna)*

Meeting death in rajas, he is born among those attached to action; and dying in tamas, he is born in the wombs of the deluded.

14.16 *(Krishna)*

The fruit of good action, they say, is of the nature of sattva and untainted; but the fruit of rajas is pain, and the fruit of tamas is ignorance.

14.17 *(Krishna)*

From sattva is born knowledge, from rajas greed, and from tamas come carelessness, delusion, and ignorance.

14.18 *(Krishna)*

Those settled in sattva rise upward; those in rajas stay in the middle; those in tamas, settled in the lowest disposition, sink downward.

14.19 *(Krishna)*

When the seer perceives no doer other than the gunas, and knows what is beyond the gunas, he attains my being.

14.20 *(Krishna)*

Passing beyond these three gunas, which are the source of the body, the embodied one is freed from birth, death, old age, and sorrow, and attains the deathless.

14.21 *(Arjuna)*

By what marks is the one who has passed beyond these three gunas known, O lord? How does he act, and how does he cross beyond these three gunas?

14.22 *(Krishna)*

He does not shun light, activity, or delusion when they come, O Pandava, nor long for them when they go;

14.23 *(Krishna)*

seated apart, as it were, unmoved by the gunas, he stands firm and does not waver, knowing that it is only the gunas at work;

14.24 *(Krishna)*

alike in pain and pleasure, self-possessed, holding clod, stone, and gold as one, the same toward the dear and the unwelcome, steadfast, the same under blame and praise;

14.25 *(Krishna)*

the same in honor and dishonor, the same toward friend and foe, giving up all undertakings—he is said to have gone beyond the gunas.

14.26 *(Krishna)*

And he who serves me with unswerving devotion, passing beyond

these gunas, becomes able to attain Brahman.

14.27 *(Krishna)*

For I am the ground of Brahman, of the deathless and imperishable, of eternal dharma, and of absolute bliss.

Chapter 15 - Purushottama Yoga

15.1 *(Krishna)*

They speak of an imperishable ashvattha tree, its roots above and branches below, whose leaves are the hymns; he who knows it knows the Vedas.

15.2 *(Krishna)*

Its branches spread below and above, nourished by the gunas, with the objects of sense for buds; and below, its roots stretch on too, binding to action in the world of men.

15.3 *(Krishna)*

Its form is not perceived here as it is—no end, no beginning, no resting place. Having cut down this firm-rooted ashvattha with the strong axe of non-attachment,

15.4 *(Krishna)*

one must then seek that place from which, having gone, none return again, with the resolve: "I take refuge in that primal person, from whom the ancient unfolding streamed forth."

15.5 *(Krishna)*

Free of pride and delusion, the fault of attachment conquered, ever dwelling in the self, desire stilled, released from the pairs of opposites known as pleasure and pain, the undeluded reach that imperishable place.

15.6 *(Krishna)*

Neither sun nor moon nor fire lights up that place; having gone there, they do not return—that is my supreme abode.

15.7 *(Krishna)*

An eternal portion of me, becoming a living being in the world of living beings, draws to itself the senses, with the mind as the sixth, which abide in prakriti.

15.8 *(Krishna)*

When it takes on a body, and when it departs from one, it carries these along, as the wind carries scents from their places.

15.9 *(Krishna)*

Presiding over hearing, sight, touch, taste, and smell, and over the mind, it experiences the objects of senses.

15.10 *(Krishna)*

The deluded do not see it as it departs, abides, or experiences, joined with the gunas; those with the eye of knowledge see it.

15.11 *(Krishna)*

The yogins who strive see it seated in the self; but the witless, their selves untrained, do not see it, even though they strive.

15.12 *(Krishna)*

The light that dwells in the sun and lights up the whole world, and that which is in the moon and in fire—know that light to be mine.

15.13 *(Krishna)*

And entering the earth, I uphold all beings by my power; becoming the moon, full of sap, I nourish all the plants.

15.14 *(Krishna)*

Becoming the fire of digestion, dwelling in the bodies of living beings, joined with the inward and outward breaths, I digest the four kinds of food.

15.15 *(Krishna)*

I am seated in the heart of all; from me come memory, knowledge, and their loss; I am what is to be known through all the Vedas; I am the author of the Vedanta and the knower of the Vedas.

15.16 *(Krishna)*

There are two persons in the world, the perishable and the imperishable: the perishable is all beings, the unchanging is called the

imperishable.

15.17 *(Krishna)*

But there is another, the supreme person, called the supreme Atman, the imperishable lord who enters the three worlds and sustains them.

15.18 *(Krishna)*

Since I surpass the perishable and am higher even than the imperishable, I am renowned in the world and in the Vedas as Purushottama, the supreme person.

15.19 *(Krishna)*

He who, undeluded, thus knows me as the supreme person knows all; he worships me with his whole being, O Bharata.

15.20 *(Krishna)*

Thus I have taught you this most secret teaching, O blameless one; knowing it, one becomes wise, his task accomplished, O Bharata.

Chapter 16 - Daivasura-Sampad Vibhaga Yoga

16.1 *(Krishna)*

Fearlessness, purity of heart, steadfastness in the yoga of knowledge, charity, self-restraint, sacrifice, study of scripture, austerity, and uprightness;

16.2 *(Krishna)*

nonviolence, truth, freedom from anger, renunciation, calm, freedom from slander, compassion for all beings, freedom from greed, gentleness, modesty, and steadiness;

16.3 *(Krishna)*

vigor, patience, fortitude, purity, freedom from malice and from pride—these belong to one born to a divine lot, O Bharata.

16.4 *(Krishna)*

Hypocrisy, arrogance, conceit, anger, harshness, and ignorance belong, O Partha, to one born to a demonic lot.

16.5 *(Krishna)*

The divine lot leads to liberation, the demonic to bondage; do not grieve, O Pandava—you are born to a divine lot.

16.6 *(Krishna)*

In this world there are two orders of created beings, the divine and the demonic; the divine has been described at length, now hear from me of the demonic, O Partha.

16.7 *(Krishna)*

The demonic do not know either action or its cessation; in them is found neither purity, nor right conduct, nor truth.

16.8 *(Krishna)*

They say that the world is without truth, without foundation, without a lord, born merely from mutual union and caused by desire

alone.

16.9 *(Krishna)*

Holding to this view, these lost souls of feeble understanding and cruel deeds rise up as enemies for the ruin of the world.

16.10 *(Krishna)*

Clinging to insatiable desire, full of hypocrisy, pride, and arrogance, holding false notions through delusion, they act on impure resolves.

16.11 *(Krishna)*

Given over to measureless cares that end only with death, holding the satisfaction of desires to be the highest, certain that this is all,

16.12 *(Krishna)*

bound by a hundred cords of hope, devoted to desire and anger, they strive to amass hoards of wealth, by foul means, for the enjoyment of desires.

16.13 *(Krishna)*

"This I have gained today; this longing I shall now fulfill; this is mine, and this wealth too shall be mine;

16.14 *(Krishna)*

that foe I have slain, and I shall slay the others too; I am the lord, I am the enjoyer, I am successful, strong, and happy;

16.15 *(Krishna)*

I am rich and high-born; who else is equal to me? I will sacrifice, I will give, I will rejoice"—so they say, deluded by ignorance.

16.16 *(Krishna)*

Led astray by many fancies, caught in the net of delusion, addicted to the enjoyment of desires, they fall into a foul hell.

16.17 *(Krishna)*

Self-important, stubborn, filled with the pride and intoxication of

wealth, they offer sacrifices in name only, with show and contrary to the rules.

16.18 *(Krishna)*

Clinging to ego, strength, insolence, desire, and anger, these spiteful people hate me in their own and others' bodies.

16.19 *(Krishna)*

These haters, cruel and base among men, the worst of the world, I hurl again and again into demonic wombs, into the rounds of samsara.

16.20 *(Krishna)*

Cast into demonic wombs, birth after birth, the deluded, never reaching me, O son of Kunti, sink from there to the lowest state.

16.21 *(Krishna)*

Threefold is this gate of hell, ruin of the self: desire, anger, and greed; therefore one should give up these three.

16.22 *(Krishna)*

Freed from these three gates of darkness, O son of Kunti, a person works for his own good and so reaches the supreme goal.

16.23 *(Krishna)*

But he who casts aside the rule of scripture and acts on the urge of desire reaches neither perfection, nor happiness, nor the supreme goal.

16.24 *(Krishna)*

Therefore let scripture be your measure in deciding what should and should not be done; knowing what the rule of scripture declares, you should act here in the world.

Chapter 17 - Shraddha-Traya Vibhaga Yoga

17.1 *(Arjuna)*

Those who, setting aside the rule of scripture, yet worship with faith—what is their standing, O Krishna? Sattva, rajas, or tamas?

17.2 *(Krishna)*

The faith of the embodied is of three kinds, born of their own nature—sattvic, rajasic, and tamasic; hear of it.

17.3 *(Krishna)*

The faith of each, O Bharata, accords with his nature; a person is made of faith—as his faith is, so is he.

17.4 *(Krishna)*

The sattvic worship the gods; the rajasic, the yakshas and rakshasas; and the others, the tamasic, worship the dead and the hosts of spirits.

17.5 *(Krishna)*

Those who practice fierce austerities not enjoined by scripture, full of hypocrisy and ego, driven by the force of desire and attachment,

17.6 *(Krishna)*

tormenting, in their folly, the cluster of elements within the body, and me too who dwell within—know them to be of demonic resolve.

17.7 *(Krishna)*

Food, too, dear to each, is of three kinds, and so are sacrifice, austerity, and giving; hear how they differ.

17.8 *(Krishna)*

Foods that are juicy, smooth, firm, and pleasing to the heart are dear to the sattvic; they foster life, vitality, strength, health, ease, and good cheer.

17.9 *(Krishna)*

Foods that are bitter, sour, salty, very hot, sharp, harsh, and burning are craved by the rajasic, and bring pain, grief, and sickness.

17.10 *(Krishna)*

Food that is stale, tasteless, putrid, or left overnight, along with leavings and what is unfit for offering, is dear to the tamasic.

17.11 *(Krishna)*

The sacrifice offered as enjoined, by those who seek no fruit, their minds settled that it is simply to be done—that is sattvic.

17.12 *(Krishna)*

But the sacrifice offered with an eye to its fruit, or for show, know that to be rajasic, O best of the Bharatas.

17.13 *(Krishna)*

A sacrifice offered against the rules, with no food distributed, without sacred words, without the priestly fee, and without faith, they call tamasic.

17.14 *(Krishna)*

Worship of the gods, the brahmins, teachers, and the wise; purity, uprightness, celibacy, and nonviolence—these are called austerity of the body.

17.15 *(Krishna)*

Speech that gives no offense, truthful, kindly, and beneficial, and the regular recitation of scripture—this is called austerity of speech.

17.16 *(Krishna)*

Serenity of mind, gentleness, silence, self-control, and purity of heart—this is called austerity of the mind.

17.17 *(Krishna)*

This threefold austerity, practiced with supreme faith by the steadfast who seek no fruit, is called sattvic.

17.18 *(Krishna)*

Austerity done for the sake of respect, honor, and reverence, or with hypocrisy, is called rajasic here—unsteady and fleeting.

17.19 *(Krishna)*

Austerity done with deluded obstinacy, by torturing oneself, or to harm another, is called tamasic.

17.20 *(Krishna)*

A gift given because it ought to be given, with no thought of return, in the right place and time and to a worthy person, is held to be sattvic.

17.21 *(Krishna)*

But a gift given for the sake of return, or with an eye to its fruit, or grudgingly, is held to be rajasic.

17.22 *(Krishna)*

A gift given at the wrong place and time, to the unworthy, without respect or with contempt, is called tamasic.

17.23 *(Krishna)*

Om Tat Sat—this is held to be the threefold designation of Brahman; by it the brahmins, the Vedas, and the sacrifices were ordained of old.

17.24 *(Krishna)*

Therefore the acts of sacrifice, gift, and austerity prescribed by the rules are always begun with the utterance 'Om' by the expounders of Brahman.

17.25 *(Krishna)*

With 'Tat,' and seeking no fruit, the various acts of sacrifice, austerity, and gift are performed by those who long for liberation.

17.26 *(Krishna)*

The word 'Sat' is used for what is real and for what is good; and

'Sat,' O Partha, is also applied to a praiseworthy act.

17.27 *(Krishna)*

Steadfastness in sacrifice, austerity, and gift is also called 'Sat,' and action for the sake of that is likewise called 'Sat.'

17.28 *(Krishna)*

Whatever is offered or given or done as austerity without faith is called 'Asat,' O Partha; it counts for nothing, here or hereafter.

Chapter 18 - Moksha-Sannyasa Yoga

18.1 *(Arjuna)*

I wish to know, O mighty-armed one, the truth of renunciation, and of relinquishment as well, each apart, O Hrishikesha, slayer of Keshin.

18.2 *(Krishna)*

The giving up of desire-driven actions, the sages call renunciation; the surrender of the fruit of all actions, the discerning call relinquishment.

18.3 *(Krishna)*

Action should be given up as an evil, say some thoughtful men; others say the acts of sacrifice, gift, and austerity should not be given up.

18.4 *(Krishna)*

Hear my conclusion on this relinquishment, O best of the Bharatas; for relinquishment, O tiger among men, is declared to be of three kinds.

18.5 *(Krishna)*

Acts of sacrifice, gift, and austerity should not be given up but performed; for sacrifice, gift, and austerity are purifiers of the wise.

18.6 *(Krishna)*

Yet even these actions should be done giving up attachment and their fruits; this, O Partha, is my settled and highest conviction.

18.7 *(Krishna)*

But the giving up of an enjoined action is not fitting; to abandon it through delusion is held to be tamasic.

18.8 *(Krishna)*

He who gives up an action merely as troublesome, fearing bodily pain, performs a rajasic relinquishment and gains no fruit of it.

18.9 *(Krishna)*

But when an enjoined action is done simply because it ought to be, O Arjuna, giving up attachment and fruit—that relinquishment is held sattvic.

18.10 *(Krishna)*

The relinquisher filled with sattva, wise and free of doubt, neither shuns disagreeable action nor clings to agreeable action.

18.11 *(Krishna)*

For the embodied cannot give up actions entirely; but he who gives up the fruit of action is called a relinquisher.

18.12 *(Krishna)*

For those who do not relinquish, the fruit of action after death is threefold—unwanted, wanted, and mixed; but for those who renounce, there is none at all.

18.13 *(Krishna)*

Learn from me, O mighty-armed one, these five factors, declared in the teaching of Sankhya for the accomplishment of all actions:

18.14 *(Krishna)*

the seat of action, the agent, the various instruments, the many and diverse movements, and divine providence as the fifth.

18.15 *(Krishna)*

Whatever action a person sets in motion with body, speech, or mind, right or wrong, these five are its factors.

18.16 *(Krishna)*

That being so, the one who, with untrained understanding, sees the self alone as the agent—that fool does not see truly.

18.17 *(Krishna)*

He who is free of the sense of 'I,' whose understanding is untainted, though he slay these people, does not slay, and is not bound.

18.18 *(Krishna)*

Knowledge, the object of knowledge, and the knower—these are the threefold spur to action; the instrument, the act, and the agent—these are the three components of action.

18.19 *(Krishna)*

Knowledge, action, and the agent are said, in the reckoning of the gunas, to be of three kinds, by the difference of the gunas; hear of these too, as they are.

18.20 *(Krishna)*

The knowledge by which one sees in all beings a single, imperishable being, undivided amid the divided—know that knowledge to be sattvic.

18.21 *(Krishna)*

But the knowledge that sees in all beings only manifold separate beings, each apart—know that knowledge to be rajasic.

18.22 *(Krishna)*

But the knowledge that clings to one single thing as if it were the whole, without reason, missing the truth, and narrow—that is called tamasic.

18.23 *(Krishna)*

Action that is enjoined, done without attachment, without craving or aversion, by one who seeks no fruit, is called sattvic.

18.24 *(Krishna)*

But action done with great effort by one seeking to satisfy desire, or out of egotism, is called rajasic.

18.25 *(Krishna)*

Action undertaken through delusion, heedless of its consequence, of loss and harm, and of one's own power, is called tamasic.

18.26 *(Krishna)*

An agent free of attachment and ego, possessed of resolve and zeal, unmoved in success and failure, is called sattvic.

18.27 *(Krishna)*

An agent driven by passion, craving the fruit of action, greedy, cruel, impure, swept by joy and grief, is called rajasic.

18.28 *(Krishna)*

An agent undisciplined, vulgar, stubborn, dishonest, malicious, slothful, despondent, and procrastinating is called tamasic.

18.29 *(Krishna)*

Now hear, O Dhananjaya, the threefold division of understanding and of resolve, according to the gunas, set out fully and one by one.

18.30 *(Krishna)*

The understanding that knows action and renunciation, what is to be done and not done, fear and fearlessness, bondage and liberation, O Partha, is sattvic.

18.31 *(Krishna)*

The understanding by which one wrongly grasps dharma and adharma, and what is to be done and not done, O Partha, is rajasic.

18.32 *(Krishna)*

The understanding that, wrapped in darkness, takes adharma to be dharma and sees all things inverted, O Partha, is tamasic.

18.33 *(Krishna)*

The resolve by which one holds steady the workings of the mind, the breath, and the senses, through unwavering yoga—that resolve, O Partha, is sattvic.

18.34 *(Krishna)*

But the resolve by which one clings, with attachment to fruit, to dharma, pleasure, and wealth, longing for their reward, O Partha, is

rajasic.

18.35 *(Krishna)*

The resolve by which the dull-witted will not let go of sleep, fear, grief, despair, and folly—that resolve, O Partha, is tamasic.

18.36 *(Krishna)*

Now hear from me, O best of the Bharatas, the threefold happiness, that in which one comes to delight through practice and reaches the end of suffering.

18.37 *(Krishna)*

The happiness that is like poison at first but like nectar in the end, born of the serene clarity of one's own understanding, is called sattvic.

18.38 *(Krishna)*

The happiness born of the contact of the senses with their objects, like nectar at first but like poison in the end, is held to be rajasic.

18.39 *(Krishna)*

The happiness that deludes the self both at first and in the end, arising from sleep, sloth, and heedlessness, is called tamasic.

18.40 *(Krishna)*

There is no being, on earth or among the gods in heaven, that is free of these three gunas born of prakriti.

18.41 *(Krishna)*

The duties of brahmins, kshatriyas, vaishyas, and shudras, O scorcher of foes, are apportioned by the gunas that arise from their own natures.

18.42 *(Krishna)*

Calm, restraint, austerity, purity, patience, and uprightness; knowledge, realization, and faith in the unseen—these are the duty of a brahmin, born of his nature.

18.43 *(Krishna)*

Valor, vigor, fortitude, skill, not fleeing in battle, generosity, and lordly bearing—these are the duty of a kshatriya, born of his nature.

18.44 *(Krishna)*

Farming, herding, and trade are the duty of a vaishya, born of his nature; and service is the duty of a shudra, born of his nature.

18.45 *(Krishna)*

Devoted each to his own work, a person attains perfection; hear how one devoted to his own work finds it.

18.46 *(Krishna)*

He from whom all beings spring, and by whom all this is pervaded—worshiping him through his own work, a person attains perfection.

18.47 *(Krishna)*

Better one's own dharma, imperfectly done, than another's dharma well performed; doing the work set by one's own nature, one incurs no fault.

18.48 *(Krishna)*

One should not give up the work born of one's nature, O son of Kunti, even if it is flawed; for all undertakings are wrapped in flaw, as fire in smoke.

18.49 *(Krishna)*

He whose understanding is unattached everywhere, his self subdued, his longing gone, attains through renunciation the supreme perfection of freedom from action.

18.50 *(Krishna)*

Hear from me in brief, O son of Kunti, how one who has attained perfection attains Brahman as well—that highest consummation of knowledge.

18.51 *(Krishna)*

Yoked with a purified understanding, restraining the self with firmness, turning away from sound and the other objects of sense, casting off craving and aversion,

18.52 *(Krishna)*

dwelling apart, eating little, his speech, body, and mind controlled, ever absorbed in the yoga of meditation, taking refuge in dispassion,

18.53 *(Krishna)*

freed from ego, strength, pride, desire, anger, and possession, without a sense of 'mine,' and at peace—he is fit for the state of Brahman.

18.54 *(Krishna)*

Having become Brahman, serene in himself, he neither grieves nor craves; equal toward all beings, he attains supreme devotion to me.

18.55 *(Krishna)*

By devotion he comes to know me, who and how great I truly am; and knowing me in truth, he enters into me forthwith.

18.56 *(Krishna)*

Ever performing all actions, taking refuge in me, by my grace he reaches the eternal, imperishable abode.

18.57 *(Krishna)*

Surrendering all actions to me in your thought, intent on me, taking refuge in the yoga of understanding, keep your mind ever fixed on me.

18.58 *(Krishna)*

With your mind on me, you will cross over all difficulties by my grace; but if through ego you will not listen, you will be lost.

18.59 *(Krishna)*

If, relying on your ego, you think, 'I will not fight,' vain is this resolve

of yours; your own nature will compel you.

18.60 *(Krishna)*

Bound by your own work, born of your nature, O son of Kunti, what through delusion you wish not to do, you will do even against your will.

18.61 *(Krishna)*

The lord dwells in the heart of all beings, Arjuna, whirling them all about by his maya, as though mounted on a machine.

18.62 *(Krishna)*

Take refuge in him alone with all your being, O Bharata; by his grace you will attain supreme peace and the eternal abode.

18.63 *(Krishna)*

Thus I have declared to you the knowledge more secret than all secrets; ponder it fully, and then do as you wish.

18.64 *(Krishna)*

Hear again my supreme word, the most secret of all; you are greatly loved by me, and so I shall tell you what is for your good.

18.65 *(Krishna)*

Fix your mind on me, be devoted to me, sacrifice to me, bow before me; so you will come to me. I promise you truly, for you are dear to me.

18.66 *(Krishna)*

Renouncing all forms of dharma, take refuge in me alone; I will free you from every evil—do not grieve.

18.67 *(Krishna)*

This is never to be told by you to one without austerity or devotion, to one who will not listen, or to one who scorns me.

18.68 *(Krishna)*

He who shall declare this supreme secret among those devoted to me, offering me the highest devotion, will come to me beyond doubt.

18.69 *(Krishna)*

Among men there is none who does me dearer service, and there will be no one on earth dearer to me than he.

18.70 *(Krishna)*

And he who studies this our dialogue on dharma—by him I shall be worshiped with the sacrifice of knowledge; so I hold.

18.71 *(Krishna)*

And the one who merely hears it, full of faith and free of scorn—he too, set free, will attain the happy worlds of those who do right.

18.72 *(Krishna)*

Have you heard this, O Partha, with mind one-pointed? Has your delusion born of ignorance been destroyed, O Dhananjaya?

18.73 *(Arjuna)*

My delusion is gone; by your grace, O Acyuta, I have regained my memory. I stand firm, my doubts dispelled; I will do your word.

18.74 *(Sanjaya)*

Thus have I heard this wondrous dialogue between Vasudeva and the great-souled Partha, making my hair stand on end.

18.75 *(Sanjaya)*

By the grace of Vyasa I have heard this supreme and most secret yoga directly from Krishna, the lord of yoga, as he himself declared it.

18.76 *(Sanjaya)*

O king, recalling again and again this wondrous and holy dialogue of Keshava and Arjuna, I rejoice again and again.

18.77 *(Sanjaya)*

And recalling again and again that most wondrous form of Hari, great is my wonder, O king, and I rejoice again and again.

18.78 *(Sanjaya)*

Wherever Krishna, the lord of yoga, is, and wherever Partha, the archer, is, there, I hold, are fortune, victory, well-being, and steadfast right conduct.

Glossary

Concepts

Atman

True Self, Soul, or inner principle; kept distinct from ordinary ego or individual personality. *Forms: Atman | Ātman*

Brahman

The ultimate reality or absolute principle. *Forms: Brahman | Brahma-nirvana | Brahman-nirvana | Brahma-yoga | Brahma-sūtra | Brahman-realization*

dharma

Order, duty, law, or right conduct; the exact sense depends on context. *Forms: dharma | dharma-field*

guna

A quality or constituent tendency of prakriti: sattva, rajas, and tamas. *Forms: guna | gunas | guṇa | guṇas*

karma

Action, deed, or the consequences bound to action. *Forms: karma | karma-yoga*

kshetra

Field, especially the body or field of experience in Chapter 13. *Forms: kshetra | kṣetra*

kshetrajna

Knower of the field; the conscious principle related to kshetra. *Forms: kshetrajna | kṣetrajña*

maya

Power of appearance, concealment, or manifestation; context-dependent. *Forms: maya | Maya | māyā | Māyā | yoga-maya*

nirvana

Extinction, peace, or release; here often linked with Brahman. *Forms: nirvana | nirvāṇa | Brahma-nirvana | Brahman-nirvana*

prakriti
Nature, material process, or the field of change and manifestation. *Forms: prakriti | Prakriti | prakṛti | Prakṛti*

purusha
Person, spirit, or conscious principle; meaning varies by passage. *Forms: purusha | Purusha | puruṣa | Puruṣa*

rajas
The guna associated with activity, passion, impulse, and restlessness. *Forms: rajas | rājasika | Rajas | rajasic*

samsara
The ongoing cycle of worldly becoming, birth, death, and attachment. *Forms: saṃsāra | samsara*

Sankhya
A path or framework of discriminative knowledge; here not always a formal school label. *Forms: Sankhya | Sāṅkhya | Sāṅkhyas | Sāṅkhya-yoga*

Sat
Being, truth, or goodness; in 17.23 part of the sacred formula Om Tat Sat. *Forms: Sat*

sattva
The guna associated with clarity, balance, and illumination. *Forms: sattva | sāttvika | Sattva | sattvic*

tamas
The guna associated with inertia, dullness, confusion, and obstruction. *Forms: tamas | tāmasika | Tamas | tamasic*

Vedanta
The end or culmination of the Vedas; in the text, the knowledge taught by the Vedic tradition. *Forms: Vedanta*

yoga
Discipline or practice, or spiritual path toward steadiness and liberation. Literal meaning is ”yoking”, ”uniting” (from the root yuj). *Forms: yoga | karma-yoga | buddhi-yoga | Sāṅkhya-yoga | bhakti-yoga*

/ practice-yoga / yoga-maya

yogin
One who practices yoga *Forms: yogīn / yogin / yogi / yogini*

Social and ritual terms

Brahmin
A member of the priestly or learned class; Sanskrit brāhmaṇa. *Forms: Brahmin / brahmin / brāhmaṇa / brāhmaṇas*

kshatriya
Member of the warrior or ruling class. *Forms: kshatriya / kṣatriya*

Om
Sacred syllable used as a concise sign of the absolute or divine. *Forms: Om / AUM*

shudra
Member of the service class in the traditional varna scheme. *Forms: śūdra / śūdras / shudra / shudras*

Tat
Sacred formula meaning 'That', part of the expression Om Tat Sat. *Forms: Tat*

vaishya
Member of the class associated with trade, agriculture, and herding. *Forms: vaiśya / vaiśyas / vaishya / vaishyas*

Vedas
Ancient sacred texts of the Vedic tradition. *Forms: Veda / Vedas / Ṛg / Sāma / Bṛhat-sāma / Gāyatrī / Rig / Yajur / Sama / Gayatri / Brihat-sama*

yajna
Sacrifice, ritual offering, or consecrated action. *Forms: yajna / yajña*

Names and epithets

Acyuta

Epithet of Krishna, often glossed as the unfailing one. *Forms: Acyuta*

Arjuna

Arjuna, the warrior addressed by Krishna. *Forms: Arjuna*

Bhagavan

Honorific title for the Lord or Blessed One, used for Krishna. *Forms: Bhagavan*

Bharata

A dynastic or ancestral name, often used as an address. *Forms: Bharata | Bhārata | Bharatas | Bhāratas*

Bhima

One of the Pandavas, brother of Arjuna. *Forms: Bhima*

Bhishma

Elder of the Kuru dynasty and leading warrior on the Kaurava side. *Forms: Bhishma*

Brahma

The creator god; distinct from Brahman, the ultimate reality. *Forms: Brahma | Brahma's*

Dhananjaya

Epithet of Arjuna, often understood as winner of wealth. *Forms: Dhananjaya | Dhanañjaya*

Dhritarashtra

The blind king of the Kurus, father of the Kauravas; he opens the dialogue by asking Sanjaya what happened at Kurukshetra. *Forms: Dhritarashtra | Dhritarashtra's*

Draupadi

Wife of the Pandavas. *Forms: Draupadi*

Drona

Teacher of the Kuru princes and warrior on the Kaurava side. *Forms:*

Drona

Drupada
King of Panchala, father of Draupadi and Dhrishtadyumna. *Forms: Drupada*

Duryodhana
Leader of the Kauravas and son of Dhritarashtra. *Forms: Duryodhana*

Govinda
Epithet of Krishna. *Forms: Govinda*

Gudakesha
Epithet of Arjuna, commonly linked with mastery over sleep. *Forms: Guḍākeśa | Gudakesha*

Hari
Epithet of Krishna or Vishnu. *Forms: Hari*

Hrishikesha
Epithet of Krishna, often understood as lord of the senses. *Forms: Hṛṣīkeśa | Hrishikesha*

Ikshvaku
Ancient king who receives the teaching from Manu. *Forms: Ikshvaku*

Janardana
Epithet of Krishna. *Forms: Janardana | Janārdana*

Karna
Warrior allied with Duryodhana on the Kaurava side. *Forms: Karna*

Kaunteya
Epithet of Arjuna: son of Kunti. *Forms: Kaunteya*

Keshava
Epithet of Krishna. *Forms: Keshava | Keśava*

Krishna
Krishna, speaker of the teaching to Arjuna. *Forms: Krishna | Kṛṣṇa*

Kuru
The Kuru lineage or its members; context may refer to the wider

dynasty or the Kaurava side. *Forms: Kuru | Kurus*

Kurukshetra
The battlefield where the dialogue takes place. *Forms: Kurukshetra*

Madhava
Epithet of Krishna. *Forms: Madhava | Mādhava*

Madhusudana
Epithet of Krishna: slayer of Madhu. *Forms: Madhusudana | Madhusūdana*

Manu
Ancient progenitor or lawgiver who receives the teaching from Vivasvan. *Forms: Manu*

Pandava
One of the sons or descendants of Pandu; often refers to Arjuna and his brothers. *Forms: Pāṇḍava | Pāṇḍavas | Pandava | Pandavas*

Partha
Epithet of Arjuna: son of Pritha/Kunti. *Forms: Partha | Pārtha*

Prajapati
Lord of creatures; a creator figure. *Forms: Prajapati*

Purushottama
The Supreme Person: epithet of Krishna indicating the supreme reality that transcends both the perishable and the imperishable *Forms: Purushottama*

Sanjaya
Narrator of the dialogue to Dhritarashtra. *Forms: Sanjaya*

Varuna
Vedic deity associated with cosmic order and waters. *Forms: Varuna*

Vasudeva
Name or epithet of Krishna, son of Vasudeva. *Forms: Vāsudeva | Vasudeva*

Vishnu
A divine name associated with Krishna in the text. *Forms: Vishnu*

Vivasvan
Solar deity to whom Krishna says he first taught this yoga. *Forms: Vivasvan*

Yama
Deity associated with death and restraint. *Forms: Yama*